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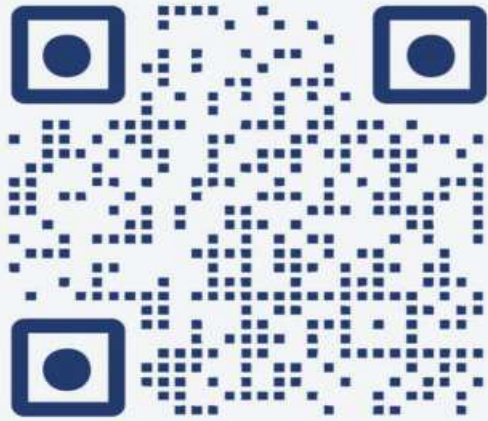
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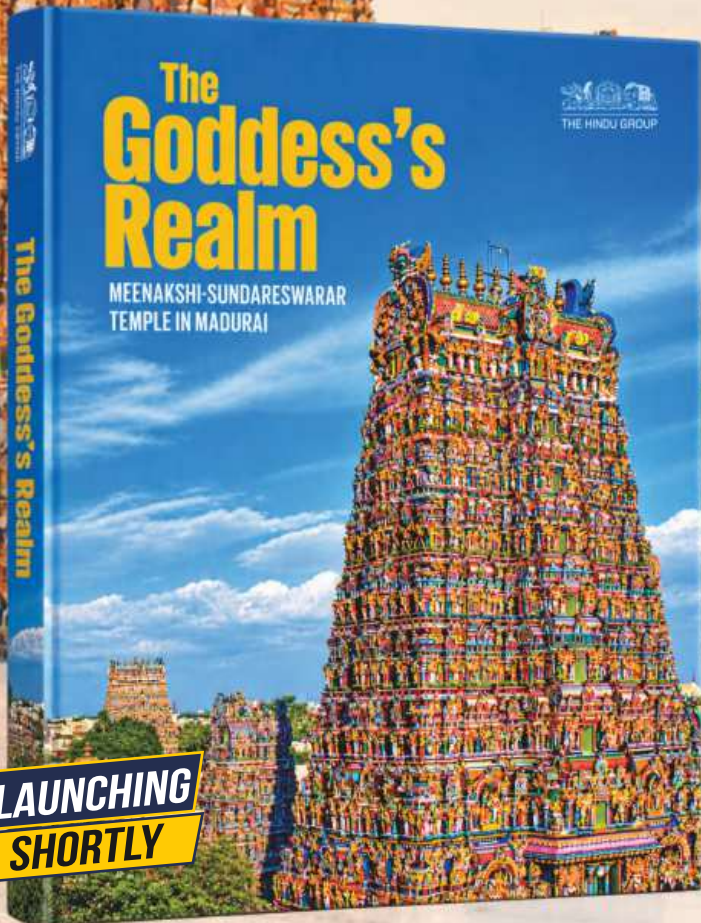


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INBRIEF



Awareness rally conducted to promote eye donation

An eye donation awareness rally was organised by Rajan Eye Care Hospital and Rotary Rajan Eye Bank in the city on Sunday, as part of their 24-year-long initiative to promote eye donation and encourage people to pledge their eyes. Health Minister K.G. Arunraj flagged off the rally and pledged his eyes for donation. Actors Shanthanu and Keerthi Bhagyaraj, Rotary Governor Sriram Divvuri, and Poornima K., president, Rotary Club of Madras T. Nagar, were among those present. Mohan Rajan, Chairman, Rajan Eye Care Hospital, and Sujatha Mohan, director, Rotary Rajan Eye Bank, participated.

PMK opposes construction on Pallikaranai marshland

PMK floor leader in the Assembly Sowmiya Anbumani on Sunday inspected the ongoing construction at the Pallikaranai marshland, which the party has opposed, since it would “destroy” the marshland ecosystem. Speaking to reporters, Ms. Sowmiya said the entire ecosystem consisting of fish, trees, aquatic plants would be destroyed. “The Pallikaranai Marshland acts as a floodwater drainage basin by storing water and helping replenish groundwater. Therefore, it is essential to protect this marshland. But contrary to this, the Tamil Nadu government is building a retaining wall, thereby putting residential areas at risk of being submerged in floods,” she said.

Gang murders man in Adyar to avenge its leader’s death, five arrested

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A 45-year-old history-sheeter was murdered by a gang of five on Saturday night.

The police said S. Kannan, a resident of Vannandurai in Adyar, was a B category rowdy, with several murder and attempt-to-murder cases. He was also a member of the ruling TVK party.

When he was going to a shop on Saturday night, a knife-wielding gang waiting near his house waylaid and murdered him, and fled from the scene.

The Shastri Nagar police, on being alerted, sent the body to the Government Royapettah Hospital for a post-mortem.

As per initial investigation, the murder was committed to avenge the killing of gang leader Siva. Kannan belonged to Mangalari Kandhan’s gang and there was a long-standing enmity between Siva and Mangalari Kandhan in various illegal issues. Both Siva and Kandhan were murdered several years ago.

The police arrested five persons: S. Bharani, N. Hari, P. Naresh, P. Rakesh, and D. Manikandan.

Major desilting exercise to be done in Madurantakam Tank to restore lost storage

The exercise proposes to clear about 50 lakh cubic metres of silt from the tank in a phased manner over three years; the initiative aims to recover lost storage of 94 million cubic feet

K. Lakshmi
CHENNAI

After several years, Madurantakam tank, one of the major and ancient irrigation tanks in Chengalpattu district, is set to undergo a major desilting exercise with the support of Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) funds.

With the southwest monsoon remaining 55% deficient in the district so far, the tank has less than one-third of its storage capacity. Many of the 528 tanks in the district have 50% or less of their storage capacity.

Restoring the tank’s original storage capacity is imperative as it is a significant source of irrigation and drinking water for several villages. The initiative aims to recover the lost storage of 94 mcf. and enhance groundwater recharge in the surrounding areas. The work, inaugurated on Friday, is being carried out jointly by the Chengalpattu district administration and the Water



Much-needed effort: Restoring the tank’s original storage capacity is imperative as it is a significant source of irrigation and drinking water for several villages. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Resources Department (WRD) with CSR support. Spread over 1,058 hectares, the tank’s restoration history dates back to 1798, when the then collector Lionel Place renovated the water body.

Sources in the WRD said considerable quantities of silt had accumulated on the tank bed over the years, reducing its storage capacity. Systematic desilting of the tank would help optimise storage at 791 million cubic feet and sustain irrigation across nearly 3,077.49 hectares of ayacut through the Maduranta-

kam tank system.

The tank recently underwent a restoration initiative worth ₹172.66 crore and the work largely involved strengthening the weirs and building a spillway for controlled release of flood water. While the project improved tank capacity from 694 mcf. to 791 mcf., only 5% of the silt was cleared to build foreshore bund and reclamation of agricultural lands, sources said.

The major desilting exercise proposed to clear about 50 lakh cubic metres of silt from the tank in a

phased manner over three years. This year, desilting has started in seven identified locations, targeting removal of 10 lakh cubic metres of silt.

There are plans to monitor the work through drone-based surveillance apart from field inspections. Noting that it was long-pending exercise, A. Dhanapal, president, Tamizhaga Sugarcane Farmers Association and secretary of Foundation for Organic Agriculture, said it was a need of the hour to avert a water crisis.

“Storage in most tanks is rapidly depleting, and groundwater level has fallen below 50 feet in several places like Cheyyur and Pavunjur. Many farmers are sinking additional borewells in search of water. Restoring water bodies will help availability of more water for irrigation of crops and recharge groundwater in villages,” he said. Sources said water from the tank could also potentially be tapped for water supply in Chennai southern suburbs.

‘Complete all monsoon preparedness works by end of September’

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

While instructing officials to expedite the ongoing rainwater drainage system, canal, and waterbody works in the city, Chief Secretary M. Sai Kumar told them to ensure that no inconvenience is caused to residents during the monsoon preparedness work.

He said this during inspection of works in Adyar, Perungudi, and Sholinganallur zones on Saturday.

Mr. Sai Kumar directed Water Resources Department, Highways Department, Chennai Metro Rail, and Chennai Metropolitan Water Supply and Sewerage Board, to coordinate the works and complete them by September-end.

He told officials to remove water hyacinth and silt obstructing the flow of rainwater through canals and culverts.

In Adyar, he inspected a ₹13.52-crore stormwater drain being constructed near Tidel Park to carry rainwater from the IIT-Madras area to the Buckingham Canal.

The 660-metre drain will have two water passages, each measuring 3m x 3m.

Xerxes Ranina discusses Who Owns What? and the legal right behind creative work

Priyamedha Dutta
CHENNAI

What exactly can you own when you create something? And how can young creators protect their work? These questions took centre stage at *The Hindu Lit for Life* Unplugged, presented by Prakriti Foundation on September 5, at The Lab@Shanta in T. Nagar, as lawyer and author Xerxes Ranina was in conversation with Ranvir Shah, founder-trustee, Prakriti Foundation. The conversation drew on Ranina’s new book *Who Owns What?* published by HarperCollins India.

The conversation explored everyday legal questions creators often grapple with – from copyright and contracts to what happens when someone uses their work without permission.

Mr. Ranina began by breaking down the often-



Lawyer and author Xerxes Ranina in conversation with Ranbir Shah, founder-trustee, Prakriti Foundation, at *The Hindu Lit For Life*, in the city on Saturday. R. RAVINDRAN

confused distinctions between patents, trademarks and copyright. “A trademark is a brand that you are interacting with. Adidas, Pepsi, the name and the logo both are trademark. Copyright deals with various creative works like a literary work, piece of music, theatre, photography, and films,” he said.

“Patents usually deal with an invention. So, you invent something that has an industrial purpose, and

it’s created through an industrial method, and then that’s something you can patent,” he added.

For creators, he emphasised, copyright begins much earlier than many realise. “One of the important benefits of copyright is that it accrues immediately on creation,” Mr. Ranina said. “You already own it.” This, he added, was particularly important for young creators who may assume that registration is necessary before

they can claim ownership of their work.

The conversation moved into music and traditional knowledge, where ownership becomes more complicated. Traditional forms themselves may not be protected, Mr. Ranina explained, but original additions can be. “If you add something to a traditional raga, that addition can be protected,” he said.

He also spoke about making remixes of old songs in movies, which he says the copyright laws allow under certain conditions, while social media use of the copyright material remain a complicated area. “Since so many people are using it, it can become impractical to go behind them all.”

He also touched upon personality rights, explaining that a celebrity’s likeness can extend beyond a photograph to their voice, mannerisms or distinctive style.

After 56 years in Madras, now Chennai, I would not trade it for any other city in the world, irrespective of the weather! In the Seventies, after experiencing life in other cities, I found that Madras had all the trappings of a metro city while keeping intact a simplicity, which exuded warmth and friendliness.

Outings meant a walk at the Theosophical Society, sitting under the Banyan tree, visiting residents who were so very different in their approach to life. Talking to San-kara Menon and others like Sarada teacher and Kamala Trilokekar was uplifting, and meeting Rukmini



Sabita Radhakrishna, TV anchor, textile researcher, designer, and cookbook author.

Arundale was a life experience. Carrying sandwiches and finger food, we would sit on the beach at Besant Nagar, feeding the children and just lying on the sands watching the sun go down. “Thenga Manga Pattani Sundal” were cries we looked forward to.

In the Seventies and even Eighties, it was still not daunting to drive, with controlled traffic, thanks to people who followed the road rules. You could drive right up to Broadway and still find parking places. Oh the joys of showing Moore Market to our children, and of course Burmah Bazaar! These precious voyages of discovery were organic, unhindered by the intrusion of virtual entertainment.

The looms at Kalakshetra were a joy to behold, magic worked as weft melded into warp to produce exquisite silks, some of them designed by none other than Rukmini Devi. (As told to Deepa H. Ramakrishnan)



From the archives: Russian actor G.M. Pechnikov performs the role of Rama in a stage production of the Ramayana on November 17, 1982. This photo and more are on display at *The Hindu* Made of Chennai Archival Photo Exhibit as part of Madras Month celebrations. The exhibition will be on at *The Hindu* office till September 14 and is open to the public from 10 a.m. to 6.30 p.m. on all days, except Sundays. To visit, register for free at madeofchennai.thehindu.com/

Experts discuss gut microbiomes, their impact on health

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Ultra processed food is the greatest harm that has happened to us, D. Nageshwar Reddy, founder and chairman, Asian Institute of Gastroenterology, Hyderabad, said here on Saturday.

While delivering the 22nd Professor Arcot Gajaraj Memorial Oration on ‘Gut Microbiomes: The New Revolution’, Dr. Reddy said ultra processed foods contained emulsifiers, preservatives, and colouring agents, all of which could change the microbiome dramatically. He said the research showed the importance of beneficial microbiomes. “Longevity and healthy life are related to the microbiome we have in the gut.”

In a fireside chat with Lakshmi Prashant, consultant, Kauvery Hospital, Little Ones Paediatric Clinic, Chennai, Sarath Gopalan, senior consultant, paediatric gastroenterologist and hepatologist, Madhukar Rainbow Children’s Hospital, New Delhi, said the non-nutritional aspects of feeding in children were equally important. “The level of emotional and social stimulation a child gets at the time of feeding makes a huge difference. If the feeding is an unpleasant experience, the stress will result in a disordered state in the gut,” he said.

A. Jaishree Gajaraj, chairperson of the Target Foundation and Kausalya Gajaraj Charitable Trust, also spoke.

OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

DEATH

A. ANANTHARAMAN (91), Retired Chief Personnel Manager, The Hindu, Chennai passed away on 06-September-2026. Address: 54/48, 28th Cross Street, Indira Nagar, Chennai - 600020. Contact: 9840380388

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

NINTH ANNIVERSARY

05.05.1930

07.09.2017

DAVIS JOHNSON

Remembered by Family Members

DEATH

OBITUARY

Mr A ANANTHARAMAN (91)

Retd. Chief Personnel Manager, The Hindu, Chennai passed away on 6th Sept. 2026.

Address: A. Jayam 54/48, 28th Cross Street, Indiranagar, Chennai-600020.

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OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE

[A] Name of work: Annual Maintenance contract for two (02) numbers CNC Axle Turning Lathe Machine (M/C No. 09/1113/01 & 09/1115/01). Make DANOBAT at Shop-09, Loco Works, CLW, Chittaranjan for a period of two (02) years. (OT basis). Tender Notice No.: MW-ELM_S_8_AMC_2_DANOBAT. Tender No.: MW-ELM_S_8_AMC_2_DANOBAT. Tender Type: OPEN. Bidding Style: Single Rate for Tender. Cost of Tender Document (Form): 00.00. Earnest Money to be deposited: Rupees 1,75,000.00. Approximate Value of the Work (Tender Value): Rupees 87,49,794.00 (including all Taxes). Completion Period of the Work: 24 months. Contract type: WORKS. Contract Category: Expenditure. Expenditure Type: Capital (WMS). Closing Date for Tender /Time: 21/09/2026, 13:00 hrs. Tender Validity Period : 60 (sixty) days. Complete Details of Tender can be seen in the Railways Websites: www.ireps.gov.in.

[B] Name of work: AMC of 01 (one) number Zayer Make bed type CNC milling Machine (08/2595/03) of Shop-08. Duration: 02 years. Tender Notice No.: MW-ELM_S_8_AMC_5_MZAYER. Tender Type: OPEN. Bidding Style: Single Rate for Tender. Cost of Tender Document (Form): 00.00. Earnest Money to be deposited: Rupees 40,900.00. Approximate Value of the Work (Tender Value): Rupees 20,44,282.44 (including all Taxes). Completion Period of the Work: 24 months. Contract type : WORKS. Contract Category: Expenditure. Expenditure Type: Capital (WMS). Closing Date for Tender /Time: 23/09/2026, 11:00 hrs. Tender Validity Period: 60 (sixty) days. Complete Details of Tender can be seen in the Railways Websites: www.ireps.gov.in.

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PHOTO QUIZ

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Look closely at the photograph. The film stars are presenting gold ornaments to then Prime Minister at Raj Bhavan, Guindy, in November 1965. Who is the Prime Minister pictured here?

Answer to yesterday's Photo quiz:

Padmini

Yesterday's winners:

1. Richu Roby
2. Aravinda Lochanan T
3. Shalini Gerald

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NHAI terminates contract for stalled stretch of expressway

The contractor has completed only 11.33 km of the 24-km-long Arakkonam-Kancheepuram stretch of Bengaluru-Chennai Expressway. NHAI has floated fresh tenders to complete the pending works

Deepa H. Ramakrishnan
CHENNAI

After 15 months of waiting, the National Highways Authority of India (NHAI) has terminated its contract with D.P. Jain for the delayed Arakkonam-Kancheepuram stretch of the 263-km Bengaluru-Chennai Greenfield Expressway. The NHAI has floated fresh tenders for completing the remaining works within 18 months under the engineering, procurement, and construction (EPC) mode at a cost of ₹633.12 crore. The new contractor will also have to maintain the stretch for five years. This follows the disposal of two writ appeals filed by the company in the Madras High Court.

Pending works
The company completed only 11.33 km (53.56%) of the 24.5-km-long section of the four-lane road, before halting all construction works in May 2025. The pending works include nine major bridges, a railway overbridge, two grade separators, two minor bridges, 18 underpasses, and 44 box culverts. This is the second time the NHAI has issued a termination notice to the company during the construction of the access-controlled road passing through three States. The



Fresh effort: The new contractor must complete the works in 18 months, and maintain the stretch for five years. B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

first one was issued in November 2025. While its 71-km stretch in Karnataka has been completed, the one in Andhra Pradesh is expected to be completed by the end of October. In Tamil Nadu, work has been completed on 99% of the Gudipala-Walajahpet stretch, 98% of the Walajahpet-Arakkonam stretch, and around 90% of Kancheepuram-Sriperumbudur, which needs to be connected to the trumpet interchange. Motorists have been permitted to use the former two sections. “Only the shifting of EHT (Extra High Tension) towers belonging to the Power Grid Corporation of India Ltd. and the Tamil Nadu Transmission Corporation Ltd. needs to be completed. That work is also progressing after we took up the issue with the Tamil Nadu government

for an early resolution. The three-stretch project in the State, being executed at a cost of ₹4,657 crore, will likely be ready by the year-end,” said an NHAI source. The final stretch from Gudipala to Walajahpet has border check posts on either side of the road and an elephant pass. The road, which begins on the Andhra Pradesh side of Chittoor, will pass through the Vellore, Ranipet, Kancheepuram, and Tiruvallur districts of Tamil Nadu. A retired Highways engineer said the road was not intended to connect temple towns or villages. “It is for those who want to reach Bengaluru and Sriperumbudur from the other side. Industrial development can take place along the road if land parcels are made available. This road will also be convenient for heavy vehicles, as two- and

three-wheelers will not be allowed to ply,” he added. Infrastructure enthusiast P.S. Kumar said driving on the Bengaluru section was a smooth experience. “You won’t feel the distance when you travel on this new road. Vehicles can easily touch 120 kmph. And since local vehicles and animals would not get onto the carriageway, it is safe to drive,” he said.

‘Complete stretch soon’
S. Yuvaraj of the Tamil Nadu Sand Lorry Association said the government should take steps to complete the stretch in Tamil Nadu at the earliest. “My wife and I have travelled via the completed portions in Tamil Nadu, Andhra Pradesh, and Karnataka. The road is really world-class. There are no towns nearby. Efforts must also be made to provide eateries, petrol bunks, automobile repair shops, toilets, and rest areas along the road.” Meanwhile, the Chennai-Bengaluru National Highway is being widened into six lanes in key sections. The 34-km stretch from Sriperumbudur to Kavarappettai is yet to be completed. Seventeen structures – two flyovers and 15 underpasses – are pending due to issues related to fly ash. So far, 24 km of the road has been widened.

Former Chief Personnel Manager of *The Hindu* passes away at 91

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A. Anantharaman, who retired as the Chief Personnel Manager of *The Hindu*, died on Sunday. He was 91. Mr. Anantharaman, who joined *The Hindu* in 1981, headed the personnel department. He served the organisation for more than 15 years. Previously, he had worked as Personnel Manager at Enfield India.



A. Anantharaman

The nonagenarian was an expert in personnel management and labour

studies, and served as a guest faculty at the University of Madras. He was also a guest lecturer at Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan in Mysore, the Madras School of Social Work, and other educational institutions in the State. Mr. Anantharaman is survived by his wife A. Jayam, who retired as Head of Department of Tamil at Ethiraj College, and daughter Lalithasai.

Timings CHENNAI		
MONDAY, SEP. 07		
RISE	05:58	SET 18:16
RISE	02:00	SET 15:20
TUESDAY, SEP. 08		
RISE	05:58	SET 18:15
RISE	03:03	SET 16:11
WEDNESDAY, SEP. 09		
RISE	05:58	SET 18:15
RISE	04:04	SET 16:58

THE HINDU
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Ambergris seized from house in Nerkundram

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Officials of the Anti-Narcotics Task Force (ANTF) seized from a house in Nerkundram over 9 kg of ganja and ambergris, the whale vomit whose sale is banned. The T. Nagar ANTF unit conducted the

raid after receiving a tip-off that Kamalakannan, a petrol bunk employee, sold ganja at his house. They arrested Kamalakannan, his friend Ashok Kumar who entrusted him with the ambergris, and Chelladurai. The seized ambergris was handed over to the Forest Department.

Chennai Weather	max	min
Tiruvallur	36	24
Chennai Airport	36	27
Chennai City	35	26

Chennai Airport Today
33°C The weather will be warm and humid. The night will be comfortable. A spell of moderate rain and thunder-showers will occur.

Chennai Airport Tomorrow
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No.1, Jaffar Sarang St., Vallai Seethakathi Nagar, Chennai - 600 001.
E-TENDER NOTICE **Date: 07.09.2026**
The Tamil Nadu Waqf Board invites Request for Proposal (RFP) from eligible and experienced manpower service agencies for the selection of an agency to provide manpower services on an outsourcing basis through the Two-Cover System.

Particulars	Details
E-Tender Notice No.	TNWB_MANPOWER_SERVICE_2026, dated 07.09.2026
Date of Publication of Tender	07.09.2026 at 11.00 A.M. through the Tamil Nadu Tender Portal (tenders.gov.in)
Availability of Tender Documents	From 07.09.2026 11.00 A.M. to 21.09.2026 up to 06.00 P.M.
Cost of Tender Document	Free of Cost
E-Procurement Portal	http://tenders.gov.in

DIPR/2754/TENDER/2026 **CHIEF EXECUTIVE OFFICER, TAMIL NADU WAQF BOARD, CHENNAI-600001**

GOVERNMENT OF HIMACHAL PRADESH
DEPARTMENT OF MPP & POWER
GLOBAL INVITATION OF BIDS FOR IMPLEMENTATION OF HYDRO ELECTRIC PROJECTS IN HIMACHAL PRADESH
CORRIGENDUM OF NOTICE INVITING PROPOSALS
In partial modification of Notice Inviting Proposals (NIP) for implementation of 27 Hydro Electric Projects (HEPs) upto 25 MW having total capacity 300.9 MW with free power royalty rate uniformly @12% + 1% for entire period i.e. 40 years published on 11.07.2026, which is also uploaded in the Directorate of Energy website i.e. <https://doehimachal.nic.in>, it is to inform that the last date of sale of Bid Documents, last date of submission of Bids and the date of opening of Bids are hereby extended as under :-
Last date for sale of Bid Documents : 07.10.2026 upto 1700 Hours
Tentative date of Pre-Bid Conference : 15.10.2026
Last date of submission of Bids : 30.10.2026 upto 1300 Hours (IST)
Date of opening of Bids : 30.10.2026 at 1500 Hours (IST) onwards
Note:-If the Last date for submission of Bids or the date of opening of bids happens to be a holiday declared by the Government of Himachal Pradesh in Shimla, the Bids will be submitted and opened on the next working day in the same order and at the same time.
The other terms & conditions of earlier published Notice Inviting Proposals on 11.07.2026 shall remain the same.
For & on behalf of the Governor of HP
-Sd- Director (Energy), Directorate of Energy, Govt. of HP,
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PERSONAL	LEGAL NOTICE									
CHANGE OF NAME I, SANGAM Vijaykumar s/o Vijayakumar Chennappa born on 24/06/1993 residing at 83 Hanumakka Layout BLR 560 056, have changed my name to Ksngam Mahaapini Vijayakumar vide affidavit dated 02/09/2026 at Bengaluru. I, KUMAR Setharaman s/o Setharaman, r/o: No-B 303, Bharathi Mera-k Elements-1, Anna Main Rd, New Vision Township, Vengambakkam, Tambaram-600127. Changed my name as Kumar Setharaman. I, RAMESHWARI Sureshkumar, d/o: Ganesh, r/o: S-1, Bakklam, Crystal Flat, No.18/45, PHNO-C, Kamalam Nagar, 3rd Mainroad, Manikandan Nagar, Nanmangalam, Kovilambakkam, Chennai-600129 Have Changed My Name As Rameshwari Ganesh I, CHANDRASEKAR Palanisamy, father of Srikrishnan Chandrasekar, residing at Plot No. 9, 1st Cross Street, Floss Carmeli, Muthialpet, Pudukcherry-605003, hereby declare that my minor (aged about 16 years) son's name has been changed from Srikrishnan Chandrasekar to Srikrishnan Chandrasekar vide Pudukcherry Gazette, Ordinary Gazette No. 14 dated 07.04.2026 OLD AGE HOME PALLIATIVE CARE at your home Trained Nurses, 24/7, Dr., Physio visits, Lab tests 1800-313-1883 tikotra.com/seniors FURNITURE ALL SOFAS, All Recliners, Recondition, Reupholstery KNS Rajan 7667133233 HEALTH HAPPY FOOT Reflexology, @ Shenoy Ngr. 60min-99/- Ct. 90421 82828 SITUATION VACANT GENERAL RETIRED OFFICERS Wanted- Reputed MNC Group Tambaram Part Time /Full Time Position in Financial Consultant Attractive income & Immediate Openings. Call: 8111 000 488	IN THE SUPREME COURT OF INDIA CIVIL APPELLATE JURISDICTION (RULE 8 OF ORDER XIX, SCR 2013) CIVIL APPEAL No(s) 688-690 OF 2026 <table><tr><td>COMMISSIONER OF CUSTOMS</td><td>VERSUS</td><td>...Petitioner(s)/Appellant(s)</td></tr><tr><td>M/S SINDHU LAKSHMI IMPEX</td><td></td><td>... Respondent(s)</td></tr><tr><td>To, 1 M/S SINDHU LAKSHMI IMPEX, SL NO. 15/8 KASTURI RANGAN 1ST STREET POES GARDEN TENNAMPTT CHENNAI - 600018, TAMIL NADU 2 MALAY RAJEN SHAH, M/S BNM GLOBAL VENTURES NO.401, LAXMI CUS, 17 WACHHA GANDHI ROAD GANDEVIE MUMBAI-400007 3 SARAVANAN PALANIAPPAN, PARTNER SL NO. 15/8 KASTURI RANGAN 1ST STREET POES GARDEN TENNAMPTT CHENNAI - 600018</td><td></td><td>PID: 192397/2026 FOR R[1] IN IN C.A. NO. 690/2026 C.A.NO.688-690/2026 (SEC XVII-A) PID: 192398/2026 FOR R[2] IN IN C.A. NO. 689/2026 C.A.NO.688-690/2026 (SEC XVII-A) PID: 192399/2026 FOR R[3] IN IN C.A. NO. 688/2026 C.A.NO.688-690/2026 (SEC XVII-A)</td></tr></table> WHEREAS the appeal above-mentioned filed in the Registry by Mr. GURMEET SINGH MAKKER, Advocate , on behalf of the Appellant above-named were listed for hearing before this Court on the 09th January, 2026 , when the Court was pleased to pass the following Order: "1. Heard learned counsel for the appellant. 2. Delay condoned. 3. Issue notice, returnable in six weeks." AND WHEREAS, the matter above-mentioned was listed before Ld. Registrar's Court on 28th July, 2026 , When the following order was passed:- "Application for substituted service filed by Ld. Counsel for the appellant in respect of Respondent Nos. 1 to 3 is in order, the same is hereby allowed. Ld. Counsel for the appellant is directed to file affidavit alongwith proof of paper publication by 11.08.2026. List the matter again on 31.8.2026. Copy of this Record of Proceedings be furnished to the concerned Learned Advocate-on-Record for information and compliance." "NOW, THEREFORE, TAKE NOTICE that the above appeal above-mentioned will be posted for hearing before this Court in due course when you may appear before the Court either in person or through an Advocate-on-record of this Court duly appointed by you and show cause to the Court on the day that may subsequently be specified as to why the leave to appeal may not be allowed. You may file your affidavit in opposition to the petition within 30 days from the date of publication of notice or not later than 2 weeks before the date appointed for hearing, whichever be earlier, but shall do so only by setting out the grounds in opposition to the questions of law or grounds set out in the Appeal and may produce such pleadings and documents filed before the Tribunal against whose order the appeal is filed. TAKE FURTHER NOTICE that if you fail to enter appearance as aforesaid, no further notice shall be given to you and the matter above-mentioned shall be disposed of in your absence.	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From Page One

Government mulling abolition of State Planning Commission

After the country went in for economic liberalisation in the early 1990s, the relevance of the Planning Commissions, both at the Centre and in the States, got diminished.

The plan to do away with the SPC was first announced by the AIADMK government in March 2017. It was stated then that the SPC would be replaced with the State Development Policy Council (SDPC) to advise the government on policy coherence and formulation of programmes to guide the development of the State. The SDPC came into being in April 2020. Three months after the DMK returned to power in May 2021, the SDPC was rechristened as the SPC. The content posted on the SPC website reveals that the SPC serves “as an apex advisory body which provides evidence-based policy guidance to promote holistic growth and development in the State”.

When the SPC was conceived in the early 1970s, the country was in the mode of planned development. Then, the new body’s brief was to assess the State’s resources and formulate a plan for their most effective and balanced utilisation, as reported by *The Hindu* on April 7, 1971. E.P. Royappa was made the Vice-Chairman after he was ousted from the post of Chief Secretary. After one more transfer, Royappa challenged the validity of his transfer in the Supreme Court, but lost his case.

There had been instances of civil servants heading the SPC: V. Karthikeyan in 1983 and C.V.R. Panikar in 1985. However, after M. Karunanidhi of the DMK came back to power in January 1989, the practice of naming the incumbent Chief Minister as the ex-officio head was revived. This has been the practice since then. Several leaders such as K.A. Mathiazhagan (1974), V. Ramaiah (1976), Kovai Chezhan (1978), M. Muthuswami (1983), V. R. Nedunchezian (1992-the then Finance Minister too), and C. Ponnaiyan (2020) were made Vice-Chairpersons. In 2011, it was the turn of veteran civil servant Santha Sheela Nair to hold the post of Vice-Chairperson.

Economists M. Naganathan and J. Jeyaranjan had also served as the Vice-Chairpersons of the Planning Commission when the DMK was in power. Mr. Naganathan held the post during 2006-11 and Mr. Jeyaranjan during 2021-26. At the end of his term, Mr. Jeyaranjan was designated as the Executive Vice-Chairperson.

T.N. launches third phase of underwater archaeological survey off Poompuhar coast

The exploration has been planned for nearly 20 days, after the team took into consideration the ocean currents’ patterns and Northeast monsoon. The last survey was carried out in Sept. 2025

N. Sai Charan
CHENNAI

In another step forward in tracing the maritime trade links of the ancient Tamils, the Tamil Nadu State Department of Archaeology (TNSDA) commenced the third phase of underwater archaeological exploration off the coast of Poompuhar, the ancient port city once known as Kaveri-poompattinam, in Mayiladuthurai district on Sunday.

Minister for School Education Rajmohan, who also holds the Archaeology portfolio, launched the underwater archaeological exploration at Poombuhar along with Director of Archaeology V.P. Jayaseelan, renowned archaeologist and scholar K. Rajan, former Joint Director of the TNSDA R. Sivanantham, and Joint Director (in-charge) V.P. Yathees Kumar.

Mr. Rajmohan and Mr. Jayaseelan also dived into the sea along with a team of trained divers and archaeologists. Mr. Jayaseelan told *The Hindu* the team set out to sea on a mechanised boat from a village between Thirumullaivasal and Poombuhar, went nearly two kilo-



Diving into the past: Minister Rajmohan and the team of experts carrying out archaeological survey off the Poombuhar coast in Mayiladuthurai district on Sunday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

metres into the sea and dived to a depth of 10 metres to look for structures. He also said the visibility was relatively limited underwater.

Considering the pattern of ocean currents and the upcoming northeast monsoon season, the experts have planned to conduct the underwater exploration off the Poombuhar coast for nearly 20 days. This was the first time an underwater archaeological exploration had been carried out off the Poombuhar coast after the new government led by Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay assumed office.

During the previous



The team set out to sea on a mechanised boat from a village between Thirumullaivasal and Poombuhar, went nearly two kilometres into the sea, and dived to a depth of 10 metres to look for structures

V.P. JAYASEELAN
Director of Archaeology

DMK regime, the underwater archaeological exploration off the Poombuhar coast was carried out by the TNSDA in collaboration with Indian Maritime Un-

iversity in September 2025. A team of archaeological experts conducted the exploration last year using advanced marine exploration instruments, including a remotely operated vehicle, side-scan sonar, sub-bottom profiler and multibeam scanner, to map the ocean floor.

Several literary works from the Sangam period, including Pattinappaalai, Silappadikaram and Manimekalai, as well as post-Sangam literature, contain references to the ancient port city of Poombuhar, its settlements and the maritime trade that flourished with Sri Lanka, Southeast Asia and the West.



Quality check: A team at Joyalukkas Group inspecting the gold rings before they are dispatched. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Jewellers commence dispatches for ‘Thai Maaman Thanga Mothiram Thittam’

Sangeetha Kandavel
CHENNAI

With the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK)-led government preparing to launch the ‘Thai Maaman Thanga Mothiram Thittam’, Joyalukkas Group and Kalyan Jewellers, the two jewellers awarded the tender for the scheme, have begun dispatching consignments from their facilities.

Under the scheme, a one gram gold ring will be provided to newborn babies delivered at government hospitals in the state, whose parents are residents of Tamil Nadu. A sum of ₹560 crore was allocated in the Revised Budget Estimates for this scheme. Work orders were issued to Joyalukkas and Kalyan Jewellers in a 70:30 ratio for the supply of one gram gold rings. “Shipping has commenced. The supply and dispatch process is being carried out in coordination with the State government and in accordance with the distribution and delivery mechanisms prescribed under the scheme,” Joy Alukkas, chairman and managing director of Joyalukkas Group, said.

“For the first of the four lots, Joyalukkas has been entrusted with the manufacture and supply of 89,955 rings,” he said. The rings are packed in a pouch specially designed exclusively for the project, with the ‘Thai Maaman Thanga Mothiram Thittam’ initiative clearly mentioned on the packaging. The company said it had gi-

ven particular attention in ensuring the packaging was secure. “The rings are being manufactured through our supplier network and packed at our two dedicated hubs in Chennai and Coimbatore. This enables us to manage quality control, security, and dispatch in a concentrated and systematic manner.”

Joyalukkas Group had emerged as the lowest bidder (L1) by quoting a nominal ₹0.01 towards making charges, hallmarking, insurance, and transportation, excluding the cost of gold.

“We are supplying the required volume of 38,550 rings in planned lots. The ring consignment moves from our manufacturing unit to the head office for packaging before dispatch. Dispatches and deliveries are being managed in batches ahead of schedule to cover all 107 locations,” said T.S. Kalyanaraman, managing director, Kalyan Jewellers. Responding to a query on how the deal would remain feasible amid fluctuations in gold prices, he said: “With fully integrated manufacturing, structured logistics coordination, and real-time order tracking, we are able to maintain tight operational control and stay on top of market movements.”

According to Mr. Alukkas, “From a commercial standpoint, the government pays for the gold at the prevailing market rate, while our responsibility covers the manufacture, hallmarking, secure packaging, and distribution of the rings.”

Stalin demands resolution in Assembly for proper caste census



M.K. Stalin

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

DMK president and former Chief Minister M.K. Stalin on Sunday urged the State government to adopt a resolution in the Tamil Nadu Assembly urging the Centre to conduct a proper caste census to ascertain the socio-economic status of Other Backward Classes (OBCs) in the country,

evolve an appropriate reservation policy, and ensure the empowerment of OBCs.

In a social media message, he said the objective of the caste census could be achieved only if the census was conducted based on a list of communities prepared by the Central and the State governments.

He said the “open-end-

ed format to record caste details without a pre-determined drop-down list or standardised menu”, as announced by the Centre, was disappointing. The explanation that the communities listed in the OBC list were not castes but classes was also not acceptable, he said.

Mr. Stalin said the Centre should consult the State governments and col-

lect details of the castes listed under the Backward Classes and Most Backward Classes categories. People should be given an opportunity to choose a caste from the combined list, he said.

“If castes are collected based on the suggestions of the people, it will only create confusion. As already pointed out by those interested in social justice, it

will result in claims relating to 46 lakh communities,” he said.

‘Waste of money, labour’

Mr. Stalin said if the present method was followed, it would result in the waste of ₹12,000 crore and the labour of government employees.

“It will not offer any benefits and will only be an eyewash,” he said.

EPS chairs AIADMK district secretaries’ meeting in Chennai



AIADMK general secretary Edappadi K. Palaniswami and other functionaries during the meeting at the party’s head office in Chennai on Sunday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

AIADMK general secretary Edappadi K. Palaniswami on Sunday chaired a meeting of the party’s district unit secretaries at its head office in Chennai. Besides Mr. Palaniswami, senior leaders Tamil Magan Husain, K.P. Munusamy, and Dindigul C. Sreenivasan took part in the meeting.

Former Minister D. Jayakumar, R.B. Udhayakumar, Agri S.S. Krishnamurthy, K.C. Karuppannan, K.T. Rajenthra Bhalaji, and O.S. Manian were among those who participated.

When asked if he expected anything in Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay’s speech in the Assembly scheduled for Monday, AIADMK functionary and former Minister Sellur K. Raju said the Chief Minister would be speaking after having undertaken a rehearsal. “He [Mr. Vijay] will come after doing a rehearsal. He will come as if he is coming for a [film] shooting. He will memorise and deliver punchlines, but the people are worried about the rising prices of essential commodities, be it onions, oil, or rice,” he added.

Review order on micro, nano plastics warning on food, drink packaging, FSSAI urges court

Mohamed Imranullah S.
CHENNAI

The Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) has urged the Madras High Court to review its order mandating that drinking water, sugar, and salt sold in plastic bottles and packets must contain a warning in bold and red letters that read: “This water/sugar/salt may contain micro/nano plastics”.

In the review application filed before the special Division Bench of Justices N. Sathish Kumar and D. Bharatha Chakravarthy, FSSAI has contended that research on the subject remained inconclusive, and hence, it may not be appropriate to cause “public panic” by displaying such warnings. Filing the application through Central government senior panel counsel V. Chandrasekaran, the FSSAI said all available materials and research articles, invariably and unequivocally, stated that the harmful effects of micro and nano plastics on human body remained inconclusive and the research was at a nascent stage.

“Hence, directing the applicant (FSSAI) to issue a notification (requiring the forewarning to be printed in bold letters in all PET bottles used to sell drinking water and plastic packs used to sell sugar and salt) may cause public panic and disruption in supply chain,” the authority said.

It also said that a report relied upon by the court to issue such a direction on February 6, 2026 was only a review of various papers written by different scholars worldwide on the topic of micro/nano plastic as an emerging contaminant and that the review too does not conclusively establish harmful effects on human body.

“While some studies do suggest that there may be impact to human health from exposure to microplastics and nano plastics, the overall scientific evidence does not demonstrate that levels of microplastics or nano plastics found in foods pose a risk to human health,” the FSSAI said. It was also brought to the notice of the court that the National Green Tribunal (NGT) had taken cognisance of an ar-

ticle titled ‘Detecting microplastics in human blood’ published in *The Hindu* on March 29, 2022, and directed the Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR) to conduct further studies relating to microplastics.

“The FSSAI has written to ICMR twice requesting it to conduct the relevant research. However, the ICMR has not yet responded,” the authority said, and agreed to fund the study by the ICMR, as well as the one to be conducted by the Indian Institute of Technology-Madras at the request of Tamil Nadu government.

Its review plea, along with an application to condone the delay of 151 days in filing it, have been listed for hearing before the Special Bench on Monday.

The Union Ministry of Health and Family Welfare and the FSSAI had initially approached the Supreme Court challenging the High Court’s direction. However, Justices Vikram Nath and Sandeep Mehta of the top court on May 18, 2026 dismissed the special leave petition as withdrawn, and hence, the present review.

Carnatic musician S.R. Janakiraman passes away at 98

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Noted Carnatic musician, teacher, and musicologist S.R. Janakiraman, the last student of the late Tiger Varadachariar, died in Chennai on Friday. He was 98.

S.R.J., as he was known in music circles, was renowned for his erudite lectures and demonstrations, which once dominated the December music festival season in Chennai.

Born in Lalgudi, Janakiraman was afflicted with smallpox and lost the power of sight in one eye. He could not attend school until he was 11. After learning from Thanneerpalli Krishnamoorthy Iyer and Shaptharishi Iyer, he joined Kalakshetra in Chennai to study the Sangita Siromani course.

Music historian Lalitharam said Janakiraman’s talent was spotted by Rukmini Devi Arundale, founder of Kalakshetra. She admitted him to the class of a senior student and brought him under the direct tutelage of Tiger Varadachariar. He learnt music under the gurukula system from Tiger Varadachariar. He also learnt under Tirupampu-



S.R. Janakiraman

ram Swaminatha Pillai, Musiri Subramania Iyer, T. Brinda, Professor Sambamurthy, and P.K. Rajagopala Iyer.

Research, publications

After working as a music teacher at Madanapalle and the Tirupati Music College, he joined the Music Academy, where he continued his research and published books. He translated *Sangita Sampradaya Pradarsini*, an important text on South Indian music, into English.

He was conferred the Padma Shri and the Kalaimamani award, besides being honoured with the Sangeeta Kalacharya and several other awards.

‘TUML MLAs were offered posts, money, but stood by principles’

The Hindu Bureau
TIRUVANNAMALAI

Indian Union Muslim League (IUML) Legislature Party Leader and Vaniyambadi MLA S.S.P. Syed Farooq Basha on Sunday claimed that after the recently held Assembly polls, IUML elected representatives “were offered crores of rupees and Cabinet berths (of their choice)” by key leaders of political parties but the party “strongly stood by its principles”.

Addressing the cadre and party functionaries at the district-level general body meeting in Tiruvannamalai, he said “known key leaders of political parties” came to him and A.M. Shahjahan, IUML MLA for Papanasam constituency, and “offered crores of rupees to support the party”.

Mr. Basha said they were also given their choice of Cabinet berths. “They thought the IUML could not resist such an offer, but we were not tempted. We stood by our principles. In such a scenario, we were invited and given Cabinet berths by the TVK,” he added.

INBRIEF



Student leaders pay tribute to activist Gauri Lankesh

Student leaders on Sunday paid tribute to the late Gauri Lankesh. Speaking at an event in Bengaluru, All India Students’ Association joint secretary Danish Ali said, “We (the youth) are not friends of the people who are responsible for killing people like Gauri Lankesh.” Student Federation of India joint secretary Aishe Ghosh and CJP co-convener Ashutosh Ranka took part in the event. Mr. Ranka said if Gauri was alive, she would have been a “proud cockroach”.

₹2.38 lakh unaccounted cash seized in A.P. toll plaza search

The Anti-Corruption Bureau (ACB) seized ₹2.38 lakh in unaccounted cash during a a surprise check at the Transport Department’s toll plaza at Musunuru, near Kavali in Andhra Pradesh’s Nellore district, on Sunday. Officials found ₹68,000 lying by the road. Another ₹1.70 lakh was found in the boot of a car belonging to Motor Vehicle Inspector Banavath Gopi Naik of the district enforcement wing, Nellore, the ACB said in a press release. An investigation is under way.

Vijayendra steps up criticism as padayatra enters sixth day

The BJP’s 10-day Ballari Chalo padayatra, led by Karnataka unit president B.Y. Vijayendra, entered its sixth day on Sunday, with party leaders interacting with farmers and shepherding communities along the route to highlight their issues. “Drought relief has not reached farmers. Schools and hospitals are functioning without adequate staff. The government is reducing the number of BPL cards, thereby depriving poor families of welfare benefits,” Mr. Vijayendra said.

Siddaramaiah bats for 75% quota, release of caste count

Former Karnataka Chief Minister seeks implementation of the Socio-Educational Survey in order to achieve social justice; says he was withdrawing from electoral politics and not from public life

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

Former Karnataka Chief Minister Siddaramaiah on Sunday demanded that the findings of the Socio-Educational Survey conducted by the Karnataka State Commission for Backward Classes be made public. Speaking at a convention organised by the Karnataka State Backward Castes Federation, Mr. Siddaramaiah said the High Court had directed that the contents of the report not be made public. “I believe that everyone here, including the Chief Minister, will listen to me. The report must be implemented. You should get social justice.



Siddaramaiah at the Karnataka State Backward Castes Federation’s silver jubilee programme in Bengaluru on Sunday. SUDHAKARA JAIN

Dalits, Backward Classes and minorities should get up to 75% reservation. Everyone should get a reservation according to their population. Only then can an equal society be built,” he said. Recalling his decision to

withdraw from electoral politics, Mr. Siddaramaiah said elections had become prohibitively expensive. The former Chief Minister said he was withdrawing from electoral politics and not from public life. Deputy Chief Minister

‘AHINDA is not personal property’

BENGALURU
Prominent AHINDA leader and Minister Satish Jarkiholi, who was not invited to the convention, said AHINDA was not the personal property of anyone. “I was not invited, so I did not go... AHINDA is not the property of anyone. Anyone can claim the AHINDA identity”.

G. Parameshwara hailed Mr. Siddaramaiah for mobilising the AHINDA bloc. “He created the AHINDA movement to socially, politically, and economically strengthen communities that had been neglected,” Mr. Parameshwara said.

Karnataka seeks reduction in Cauvery release

The Bureau
BENGALURU

Ahead of the Cauvery Water Regulation Committee’s (CWRC) meeting scheduled this week, Karnataka has filed an appeal before the Cauvery Water Management Authority (CWMA) seeking a reduction in water releases to Tamil Nadu from 9,000 cusecs a day, as ordered by it, to 2,000 cusecs.

It may be noted that the CWMA had upheld the CWRC’s August 25 direction to Karnataka, asking it

Citing low inflows into reservoirs, Karnataka has sought to reduce its daily water release to T.N.

to ensure flows of 9,000 cusecs a day for 15 days from August 25 to be realised at the Biligundlu water gauge at the inter-State border. According to the CWMA’s order, the releases by Karnataka would total up to 11.66 tmc ft. Meanwhile, Karnataka has filed an appeal before

the CWMA seeking a reduction in water releases on the grounds that the inflows into its Cauvery reservoirs are very low. It has also pointed out that the southwest monsoon is set to end soon, indicating that there is no hope for the State that there will be further inflows into its Cauvery reservoirs in future.

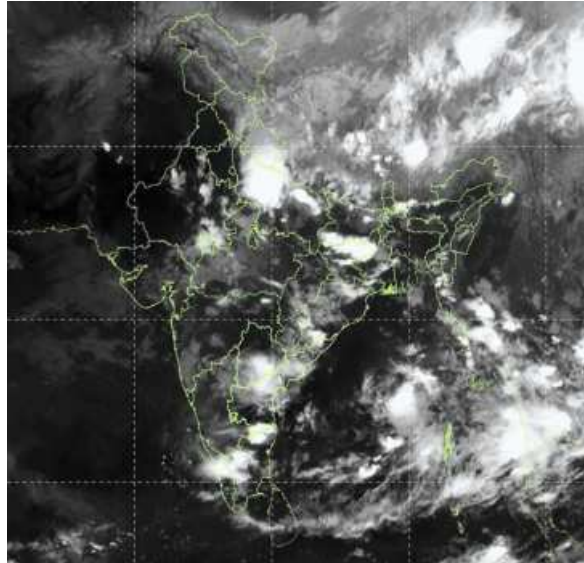
The CWRC is meeting again on September 8 to review the ground-level situation. On the same day, the CWMA is also meeting to review the situation.

It may be noted that Karnataka, on August 25, had appealed to the CWMA to adopt a cautious approach while asking for any further releases, and requested the Authority to reassess the situation after observing the forthcoming north-east Monsoon.

The State had told the CWMA that its Cauvery basin area was facing severe hydrological distress, due to which cumulative inflows into its four reservoirs in the Cauvery basin were about 49.18% below the 30-year average.

WEATHERWATCH

Rainfall, temperature & air quality in select metros yesterday



TEMPERATURE DATA: IMD, POLLUTION DATA: CPCB, MAP: INSAT/IMD (TAKEN AT 18.00 HRS)

Forecast for Monday: Heavy rainfall very likely at isolated places over Arunachal Pradesh, Assam, Meghalaya, Bihar, Nagaland, Manipur, Mizoram, Tripura, Uttarakhand, West Bengal and Sikkim. Thunderstorm accompanied with lightning and gusty winds very likely at isolated places over Andhra Pradesh

CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN	CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN
Agartala	10.0.....	31.0.....	26.5.....	Kurnool		37.4.....	26.3.....
Ahmedabad		32.5.....	26.0.....	Lucknow		32.5.....	25.5.....
Aizawl	3.0.....	31.8.....	24.5.....	Madurai	56.4.....	37.0.....	22.6.....
Bengaluru		32.2.....	22.2.....	Mangaluru		31.6.....	25.0.....
Bhopal	19.8.....	27.4.....	22.6.....	Mumbai	4.7.....	30.5.....	26.0.....
Bhubaneswar	44.4.....	34.6.....	22.4.....	Mysuru		34.2.....	19.8.....
Chandigarh	15.6.....	35.4.....	23.0.....	New Delhi	19.0.....	28.5.....	24.4.....
Chennai	0.1.....	36.5.....	27.3.....	Patna	68.1.....	33.0.....	26.2.....
Coimbatore		34.8.....	23.6.....	Port Blair	0.4.....	29.6.....	25.8.....
Dehradun	5.2.....	28.6.....	23.2.....	Prayagraj		31.6.....	26.4.....
Gangtok	3.9.....	21.8.....	18.0.....	Puducherry	1.8.....	34.7.....	25.8.....
Goa	1.0.....	32.2.....	25.4.....	Pune		28.3.....	20.6.....
Guwahati		34.0.....	26.2.....	Raipur	1.0.....	31.7.....	24.4.....
Hubballi		31.0.....	21.0.....	Ranchi		31.5.....	21.0.....
Hyderabad		33.1.....	24.6.....	Shillong			
Imphal		32.3.....	22.2.....	Shimla	2.0.....	25.0.....	15.0.....
Jaipur	24.0.....	33.0.....	24.8.....	Srinagar	0.4.....	30.2.....	14.1.....
Kochi		31.0.....	26.8.....	Thiruvananthapuram		33.3.....	25.4.....
Kohima	23.5.....	23.0.....	20.4.....	Tiruchirappalli	10.1.....	37.7.....	24.4.....
Kolkata	47.0.....	32.4.....	25.4.....	Vijayawada		36.0.....	26.0.....
Kozhikode		33.4.....	26.5.....	Visakhapatnam		35.0.....	27.8.....

Pollutants in the air you are breathing							Yesterday
CITIES	SO ₂	NO ₂	CO	PM _{2.5}	PM ₁₀	CODE	
Ahmedabad	.5	.17	166		24		■ In observation made at 4.00 p.m., Sri
Bengaluru	.5	.10	241		15		■ Ganganagar, Rajasthan
Chennai	.9	.9	282		26		■ recorded an overall air quality index (AQI) score of 186 indicating a moderate level of pollution. In contrast, Aizawl, Mizoram recorded a healthy AQI score of 19
Delhi	.41	.69	819		51		■
Hyderabad	.6	.14	291		15		■
Kolkata	.13	.13	796		38		■
Lucknow	.7	.14	383		14		■
Mumbai	.8	.10	240		12		■
Pune	.7	.10	138		6		■
Visakhapatnam	.40	.22	319		28		■

Air Quality Code: ■ Poor ■ Moderate ■ Good (Readings indicate average AQI)
SO₂: Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.
NO₂: Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.
CO: Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. At very high levels, it can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.
PM_{2.5} & PM₁₀: Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease

Aruna Parandhama

As an educator who teaches the first class of the day, I am often entrusted with a daunting task: keeping a 7:00 am classroom awake and engaged. My students are largely pursuing professional qualifications in Commerce and Business Management, and many view subjects outside their immediate career goals as peripheral, resulting in a display of restlessness in class. Over the years, I have come to see restlessness among students not as a barrier to learning but as an invitation to rethink how learning happens. Students who appear distracted, impatient, or unwilling to sit through a lecture are often capable of remarkable intellectual engagement when given the opportunity to participate, rather than merely listen.

Willing to question

One particular episode unfolded in a General English course titled Contemporary Debates I: Negotiating Identities, offered to second-year undergraduate students. It introduces learners to questions surrounding nationhood, caste, gender, multiculturalism, and other forces that shape contemporary society through literary texts and emerging forms of expression. I chose to discuss the idea of bor-



GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCK

Don’t teach, steer

With Teachers’ Day just past, an educator reflects on how restlessness among students is not a barrier to learning but an invitation to rethink how learning happens

ders through the poem Nation of Birds by K. Satchidanandan, which imagines a world in which birds move freely across territories, unconstrained by the borders that humans create and defend. The students understood the poem’s central argument almost immediately. While my intention was to ensure

that they agreed with the poet, I invited them to challenge him.

If there is one thing that adolescents are rarely short of, it is the willingness to question received wisdom. Educational psychologists like Eric Erikson and Jean Piaget have long noted that adolescence is a period marked by identi-

ty formation, scepticism, and the testing of boundaries. Rather than viewing these tendencies as disruptions to classroom order, I wanted to harness them.

I divided the class into two teams. One would defend the idea that national borders remain necessary; the other would argue against it. The only

rule was that every claim had to be challenged. Students were encouraged to use their phones to access information, verify facts, and strengthen their arguments. To make the exercise more engaging, I gave it a dramatic title: Sink or Float. The objective was to keep your team’s argument afloat while sinking the

opposing side’s position. What followed was one of the most animated discussions of the semester.

Wide-ranging discussion

Arguments emerged from all corners of the classroom. Some students insisted that borders are essential for security, governance, and national identity. Others questioned whether borders continue to serve their intended purpose in an increasingly interconnected world. One student remarked, “We are not birds; we cannot simply live without systems and structures.” Another student challenged the assumption that existing political arrangements are immutable merely because they have existed for a long time.

The discussion moved swiftly from literature to history, politics, migration, and economics. Examples ranged from contemporary debates surrounding migration across the United States-Mexico border to questions of indigeneity, ancestry, and belonging. At that point, my role had ceased as a lecturer delivering content. I became a facilitator. I steered the discussion, introduced alternative perspectives, corrected facts, and encouraged students to support their claims with evidence. Whenever an argument became overtly rhetorical or speculative, I pushed the stu-

dents to substantiate it. The learning emerged not only from my explanations but also from their engagement with one another. They were learning to construct tightly structured arguments, evaluate evidence, identify assumptions, and respectfully challenge opposing viewpoints. These are skills that extend far beyond the study of literature.

The students of today inhabit a world vastly different from the one in which we were raised. They are accustomed to interaction, immediacy, and participation. This does not mean that educators must constantly entertain students or transform every lesson into a spectacle. It means, however, that we must recognise the potential embedded within their energy.

That morning, I was reminded that meaningful learning often occurs when teachers relinquish a measure of control and allow students to take ownership of inquiry. Perhaps, then, the task of the contemporary educator is not simply to teach a restless class. It is to steer one. For within that restlessness lies the possibility of curiosity, critical thinking, and the kind of democratic dialogue that education, at its best, seeks to nurture.

The writer is an Assistant Professor, Department of English, St Joseph’s College of Commerce, Bengaluru.

SCHOLARSHIPS

Buddy4Study Gati Shakti Scholarship

An initiative by Buddy4Study. **Eligibility:** Indian students from Classes 9-12 or pursuing vocational, ITI, Polytechnic, UG or PG courses who are children/wards of heavy/light commercial vehicle drivers and have got minimum 60% in the previous class/semester and have an annual family income not exceeding ₹800,000. **Rewards:** Up to ₹30,000. **Application:** Online **Deadline:** September 30 www.b4s.in/edge/B4SGS1

Reliance Foundation Postgraduate Scholarships

Offered by the Reliance Foundation. **Eligibility:** Resident Indian citizens enrolled in the first-year of full-time PG programmes in Engineering, Technology, Energy and Life Sciences and have secured 550 to 1,000 in the GATE exam, or have a CGPA of 7.5 or above in their UG studies. **Rewards:** Up to ₹600,000 for the duration of the course of study **Application:** Online **Deadline:** October 5 www.b4s.in/edge/RFS15

Swami Dayanand India Scholarship

Offered by the Swami Dayanand Education Foundation. **Eligibility:** First-year students in full-time UG professional degree programmes (Engineering, Medicine, Dentistry, Nursing, Pharmacy, Architecture, and Veterinary Science) in India with 80% in Class 12 and an annual family income of ₹1,200,000 lakh or less. **Rewards:** Up to ₹50,000 per year. **Application:** Online **Deadline:** October 31 www.b4s.in/edge/SDIS2

Courtesy: Buddy4study.com



Steady gaze

ISRO's EOS-05 satellite has uses in varied areas from security to weather

The successful launch of the Indian Space Research Organisation's (ISRO) EOS-05 satellite is India's first earth-imaging satellite built for a geosynchronous orbit, meaning that it is locked-in to the earth's rotation and can be tuned to continuously observe the same location. The rocket placed it in a transfer orbit early on Friday; onboard thrusters are expected to raise it to its final perch at some 36,000 kilometres above the earth's surface over the coming weeks. From there it can track fast-changing events such as floods, cyclones and forest fires, and monitor crops, forests, water bodies and land use. Unlike a conventional camera, its sensors examine how the earth's surface reflects different wavelengths of light, helping distinguish vegetation, water and other land cover. Because it is perched farther away than conventional low-orbit imaging satellites, its strength is not ultra-fine detail but the ability to return to the same broad areas very frequently. India has long had eyes in geostationary orbit, but they have been weather satellites, namely the INSAT-3D series. Its dedicated earth-imaging satellites have operated in low, polar or sun-synchronous orbits. Flying a few hundred kilometres up, they capture much finer detail, but move constantly around the planet, imaging a different strip of territory on successive passes and taking days to return.

EOS-05's timing could hardly be better. Given the devastation by the Bhote Koshi deluge in Nepal, which has claimed 1,344 lives, such satellites can play some role in understanding changes in landforms and how they may act as precursors to glacier-breaks and avalanches. Or, as winter approaches in north India, in establishing whether stubble fires over Punjab have genuinely declined or burning has simply shifted in time to slip past the polar satellites. ISRO has described the EOS-05 as a "strategic" satellite, a term that stretches from security to weather. All of this is premised on the data reaching a wide enough set of analysts who can turn the images into forecasts and actionable insight. There is cheer, too, that ISRO's first successful launch of 2026 – and another vote of confidence in the cryogenic stage that failed the agency in 2021 – comes after set-backs. But that does not soften the temperamental nature of launches. Two consecutive failures of the PSLV, the agency's workhorse since the 1990s, in May last year and again this January, both traced to the third stage, suggest that dependability is not infallibility. The usefulness of its payloads, and the cadence of its launches, should be ISRO's calling card, rather than any single launch as the hallmark of institutional credibility.

Bogged down

The U.S. should revive the MoU with Iran to cut its losses

Iran's attacks on American warships outside the Strait of Hormuz and U.S. retaliatory strikes on three Iranian oil tankers in the Gulf waters mark another phase of escalation in the six-month-long war between the two countries. After the collapse of the June 17 Islamabad Memorandum of Understanding (MoU), which sought to resolve the conflict through talks, both sides have carried out tit-for-tat attacks. Last month, U.S. President Donald Trump appeared to shift the focus of his Iran policy from military strikes to economic warfare, announcing new sanctions and tightening the U.S. Navy's blockade of Iran's ports. The U.S. also managed to get some oil tankers through the Strait of Hormuz through a southern route along the Omani coast. But Iran, which still maintains its chokehold over the waterway, continued to target vessels taking the southern route. Unable to find a way out, the U.S. returned to strikes, triggering Iranian attacks on American bases in Kuwait, Bahrain and Jordan. The latest escalation is significant because it is the first time in months that Iran has attacked U.S. military vessels, apparently seeking to break the blockade. By targeting Iranian tankers in retaliation, the U.S. has also crossed a red line. The Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps announced that it had struck six vessels in the Gulf – three tankers and three U.S.-linked ships – in retaliation for the American attacks on oil tankers, and vowed to expand their strikes against U.S. ships.

The central focus of the war today, which the U.S. and Israel launched on February 28 in the name of destroying Iran's nuclear programme and bringing about regime change in Tehran, is the Strait of Hormuz. That Tehran forced the U.S. to fight over a problem it created rather than pursue Washington's original objective is, in itself, a strategic victory for Iran. The frequent clashes and counter-clashes underscore two points. First, the U.S. does not have a clear theory of victory. Neither its military effort nor its economic warfare has forced Iran to change its position. The Strait remains unsafe, while the toll on the global economy is mounting. What the Trump administration appears to be doing is 'mowing the lawn', taken straight out of the Israeli play-book, with the aim of blunting Iran's attack capabilities. But each time, Iran retaliates, pursuing its own 'debasification' strategy, pushing U.S. military presence away from its immediate periphery. Second, Iran, despite its economic woes, has emerged more assertive. The more the U.S. seeks to trap Iran in an economic gridlock, the less risk-averse Tehran appears to be. As both sides seek escalation dominance, the war risks spiralling out of control. America is visibly under pressure. Mr. Trump must to accept the cold fact that he has lost this war and return to reviving the MoU before it is too late.

Serious allegations against the Acting Chief Justice of the Rajasthan High Court, Justice Sanjeev Prakash Sharma, have come to light following reports of letters written by Supreme Court of India judge Justice Sandeep Mehta to the Chief Justice of India (CJI), in which he has sought Justice Sharma's immediate transfer. Justice Mehta, who previously served as a judge of the Rajasthan High Court and is regarded for his uprightness, discipline, and integrity, wrote three such letters on August 2, 10, and 17. The contents of these letters are now partly in the public domain.

Letters that raise serious questions

The letters reportedly refer to complaints about the manner in which Justice Sharma has been functioning. They also highlight alleged instances of victimisation of judges, maladministration, improper "shifting of cases" to his Bench, and nepotism in appointments to the Permanent Lok Adalat. Justice Sharma has allegedly been intimidating some of his colleagues with the threat of retributive measures, including transfers, based on his claimed proximity to the CJI. It is reported that Justice Mehta's letters refer to specific instances of alleged favouritism towards a chosen few among the lawyers and the misuse of power in his capacity as the "master of the roster". Justice Mehta's last letter reportedly expresses concern over the CJI's alleged inaction, particularly as Justice Sharma is due to retire on September 26. So far, there has been no official denial of the reports concerning the contents of the letters. Justice Sharma, of course, has publicly denied the accusations as baseless.

A High Court functioning without a regular Chief Justice and functioning under an Acting Chief Justice for a considerably long period – in the instant case, for about 11 months – is not a good institutional gesture. The fact that Justice Sharma was earlier transferred to the Patna High Court in 2022, and that his request for repatriation to the Rajasthan High Court was rejected by the Collegium in 2023, which instead proposed his transfer to the Punjab and Haryana High Court, is also not a commendable antecedent. Justice Mehta, according to reports, is said to have wondered how such a judge came to be retransferred to the Rajasthan High Court in 2025 and subsequently allowed to function as the Acting Chief Justice, with wide-ranging administrative and judicial powers.

Of late, there have been two crucial developments. First, lawyers at the Rajasthan High Court staged a sit-in protest on the High Court premises, following which Justice Sharma had to opt out from hearing cases. Second, on August 31, the Supreme Court Collegium recommended the appointment of Justice Sanjay Agrawal as the new Chief Justice of the Rajasthan



Kaleeswaram Raj

Lawyer at the Supreme Court of India

Allegations against a High Court judge raise serious questions about judicial accountability in India

High Court. Accordingly Justice Agrawal is now appointed.

Allegations of corruption against sitting judges in India are neither uncommon nor unprecedented. Yet, certain unique features of the present reports are worth noting. A sitting judge of the Supreme Court reportedly alerted the CJI to the conduct of an Acting Chief Justice of a High Court, supported by verifiable material.

Yet, for several weeks, no cogent steps were reportedly initiated by the CJI in this regard. The CJI reportedly said that the allegations could not be treated as findings and that they "must be dealt with strictly through the established institutional mechanism". In view of Justice Sharma's impending retirement, early action by the CJI to Justice Mehta's letter could perhaps have averted some of the disturbing events that subsequently followed.

Transparency International, in its reports, has underlined the growing trust deficit in the Indian judiciary. According to its 2002 report, based on a household survey, the judiciary was identified as the second-most corrupt institution in certain South Asian countries, including India. The report is indeed shocking. Yet, the present situation in India is far more complex and multi-dimensional. There are many fine judges in India's judiciary whose integrity and public image should not be tarnished because of aberrations elsewhere, whether on or off the Bench.

Institutional responsibility, structural issues

The repeated episodes of judicial corruption in India reflect certain fundamental issues concerning the functioning of its higher judiciary.

First, the total lack of criteria, coupled with the unavoidable collaboration between the Collegium and the Executive at the Centre under the present system, makes judicial appointments highly partisan, opaque, and often arbitrary. This mechanism and its processes are incapable of identifying the cleanest and most meritorious candidates. The issue of corruption in the judiciary, like many other institutional concerns, is inseparable from the existing method of selecting candidates for judicial office. A system of inviting applications, as is prevalent in Canada, or an independent body for judicial selection, as in the United Kingdom, remains unthinkable in India.

Second, the lack of an effective mechanism to deal with corruption in the higher judiciary in India has had the effect of perpetuating the menace. The Judges (Inquiry) Act, 1968, is inadequate to tackle the issue and has, for all practical purposes, become defunct. The Supreme Court, in *K. Veeraswami vs Union of India* (1991), held that, for registering a First Information Report against a judge of the higher judiciary, the permission of the CJI is a necessary

precondition. As lawyer Prashant Bhushan rightly observed, "the police does not dare approach the Chief Justice for permission to investigate, unless they already have clinching evidence, which they cannot get, unless they investigate" ("Judicial Accountability or Illusion?", *Economic and Political Weekly*, November 25, 2006). Although the United Progressive Alliance government facilitated the passage of the Judicial Standards and Accountability Bill in the Lok Sabha in 2012, the Bill lapsed with the dissolution of the 15th Lok Sabha in 2014. The subsequent legislative effort to revive the Bill, with some changes, also remained a non-starter. The impeachment of erring judges, as suggested by Articles 124(4) and 217(1)(b) of the Constitution, has proved to be a failure. Likewise, the in-house mechanism adopted by the Supreme Court in 1999 has not proved to be fault-free or even effective.

Earlier crises, different responses

But these considerations could not have been reasons for the CJI not to act promptly upon the concerns allegedly expressed by Justice Mehta. On the contrary, the lack of a permanent systemic solution to the issues raised should have been an additional reason for the CJI to take remedial measures expeditiously and diligently, and to do whatever was possible within his authority. The situation called for judicial statesmanship. In 1990, when an inquiry was underway against Justice V. Ramaswami for alleged misconduct, he was advised by then CJI Sabyasachi Mukharji, to take leave and keep away from judicial work.

Thereafter, when the impeachment motion against Justice Ramaswami failed in Parliament due to the Congress party's strategic abstention, the judge attempted to resume judicial work, with about nine months of his tenure remaining.

However, then CJI Venkatachaliah refused to allocate any cases to him for hearing, notes Justice K. Chandru in his book, *Who Will Judge the Judges?* (2026). Even last year, when partly burnt currency notes were reportedly found in the outhouse of Justice Yashwant Varma at his Delhi residence, then CJI Sanjiv Khanna, quickly transferred him to the Allahabad High Court, where he was not allocated any judicial work, practically. In the reported decision in *XXX vs Union of India* (2025), the Supreme Court emphasised the responsibility of the CJI in matters relating to judicial integrity and allegations of corrupt practices.

Justice Sharma allegedly claimed that the CJI is proximate to him. This was a factor that led to undesirable and avoidable speculations. Given the nature of the allegations and their immediate verifiability, it was imperative that the CJI acted promptly and convincingly, so that further damage to the system and the institution could have been reduced, if not prevented altogether.

Harnessing BRICS 'POWER' to empower the world

The 18th BRICS Summit is about to be held in New Delhi on September 12-13, 2026. China extends full support to India for its BRICS presidency, stands ready to work with all BRICS members and partners to jointly draw a blueprint for the high-quality development of a greater BRICS, and leverage BRICS POWER to empower the world. I would like to share my personal views on the greater BRICS cooperation, with the help of the five letters of the word Power.

The first is P for Principle. The world is now undergoing accelerated transformation unseen in a century, and witnessing a trend toward deepening multipolarity, economic globalisation, and the collective rise of the Global South. In the meantime, hegemonism and power politics are becoming increasingly rampant. Lingering geopolitical conflicts trigger a succession of crises and challenges.

As an important force for world peace and development, BRICS must resolutely uphold the purposes and principles of the United Nations Charter, and safeguard the basic norms of international relations, including sovereign equality, non-interference in internal affairs and peaceful settlement of disputes, and prevent the world from sliding back into the law of the jungle where the strong prey on the weak.

Upholding international principles

Chinese President Xi Jinping put forward the vision of building a community with a shared future for humanity and four global initiatives, including the Global Security Initiative and the Global Governance Initiative, which provided China's solutions on addressing common human challenges and building a better world together.

The second is O for Openness. The world economy is currently facing a sluggish recovery, coupled with the spread of protectionism. Certain countries have undermined the international economic and trade order by erecting tariff barriers, seeking decoupling and disrupting supply chains.

It should be recognised that economic globalisation is an inevitable trend of history. BRICS should uphold the multilateral trading system with the World Trade Organization (WTO)



Xu Feihong

The Chinese Ambassador to India

The five commitments for strengthening BRICS cooperation and empowering the Global South to build a more peaceful, open, and prosperous world

at its core, safeguard the basic principles of the WTO such as the most-favoured-nation treatment, and resist all forms of protectionism. We should join hands to deepen cooperation in energy and mineral resources, infrastructure, and industrial and supply chains to maintain an open global economic landscape.

China stays committed to building an open global economy, so as to share opportunities in openness, and achieve common development.

The third is W for Win-Win. BRICS should adhere to the Spirit of Openness, Inclusiveness and Win-Win cooperation. We should continue putting development at the centre of the BRICS agenda, accelerate the implementation of the UN Sustainable Development Goals, strengthen dialogue and build consensus on launching the formulation of the post-2030 global development agenda, and ensure that Global South countries participate in international cooperation as equals and share the fruits of development.

Economic and financial cooperation

We should pursue mutual benefit and win-win results to further consolidate economic cooperation. It is necessary to strengthen greater BRICS coordination on macroeconomic policies and adopt more trade and investment facilitation measures. We should push forward local currency and cross-border payment cooperation and improve the financial safety net, so as to enhance the ability to ward off external risks. In the face of global energy and food security challenges, we should build a more resilient and sustainable agriculture and food system.

The fourth is E for Engine. BRICS countries account for nearly half of the world's population, around 30% of global economic output, and one-fifth of global trade. We are also home to major natural resources, key manufacturers and vast markets. According to international agencies such as the International Monetary Fund, greater BRICS growth will be nearly three times faster than the G-7 by 2028, further highlighting its role as an engine of world economic growth.

We should leverage our respective advantages, deepen practical cooperation in fields such as business, finance, science and technology,

forging more cooperation in the digital economy, smart manufacturing, and new industrialisation. We should actively promote the integration of artificial intelligence (AI) with sectors including science and technology, health, agriculture and education, thereby injecting fresh impetus into world economic growth. China has established the China-BRICS AI Development and Cooperation Center and the China-BRICS New Quality Productive Forces Research Center, and welcomes active participation of all parties.

The fifth is R for Responsibility. BRICS countries are the main force in safeguarding fairness and justice and the backbone of promoting unity and cooperation. We must shoulder the responsibility of maintaining world peace and development. Over this year and the next, India and China will take on the BRICS rotating presidency in succession. Maintaining sound coordination between our two countries is conducive to the steady and sustained progress of greater BRICS' cooperation, and will better safeguard the common interests of developing countries.

China-India ties

Since the beginning of this year, under the strategic guidance of the two leaders, President Xi Jinping and Prime Minister Narendra Modi, China-India relations have maintained a momentum of improvement and development. The two sides strengthened dialogues at all levels and promoted exchanges and cooperation in various fields to achieve positive results. Five direct flight routes between the Chinese mainland and India have been resumed. After a six-year suspension, border trade has been reopened.

China looks forward to working with India to translate the important consensus reached by the two leaders into concrete actions, being good-neighbourly friends and partners that help each other, and pushing China-India relations to move forward in a sustained, healthy, and stable manner. May the 18th BRICS Summit in New Delhi be a great success. We welcome you all to China next year to continue empowering the world with BRICS POWER.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Dangers on highways

A series of accidents on national highways has drawn attention to the serious problem of illegal parking along highways. Even a seemingly minor instance can lead to devastating accidents. The

recent accidents seem to have drawn the government's attention to the issue and highlighted the urgent need to take effective measures to reduce the number of accidents and casualties. Strict action against illegal

parking, along with improved road safety measures, can play a significant role in preventing such tragic incidents (Front page, September 6).
Salman,
Kozhikode, Kerala

Spurious rabies vaccines

The seizure of spurious rabies vaccines and the failure of such vaccines at a private laboratory recently expose a critical breach in medical safety. Rabies has a near-100% case fatality rate once clinical symptoms

manifest, making timely, potent post-exposure prophylaxis the only defence against an otherwise almost invariably fatal disease. A fake vaccine creates a lethal illusion of security. Regulatory authorities must enforce

strict track-and-trace systems and batch verification across the supply chain.

Dr. Vijaykumar H.K.,
Raichur, Karnataka

Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the postal address.

The political cost of UCT schemes

Since 2020, Unconditional Cash Transfer (UCT) schemes have become an important electoral strategy in India, particularly to attract women voters. Some examples of such schemes include the Kalaigarn Magalir Urimai Thittam in Tamil Nadu, the Lakshmi Bhandar in West Bengal, and Gruha Lakshmi Yojana in Karnataka. Yet, despite increasing the amount of cash before the 2026 elections, some governments which implemented these schemes were defeated. One possible explanation for the loss could be the political cost associated with UCTs.

UCT schemes are well-intentioned as they provide financial support to women. They partially advance SDG (Sustainable Development Goal) 5.4, which calls for a recognition of women's unpaid domestic and care work. According to the Ministry of Finance's latest Economic Survey, States are expected to spend about \$18 billion on UCTs in 2025-26, much of it targeted towards women.

Critics, however, argue that these schemes function as electoral "freebies." Their financing often requires expenditure switching or larger fiscal deficits, and reduces resources available for productive investments, including employment generation and self-employment programmes. Moreover, once households become dependent on UCTs, withdrawing them is difficult as political parties encourage competitive welfarism.

Targeting challenges
A fundamental challenge in targeted UCT programmes is beneficiary identification. Since governments cannot



K. R. Shanmugam

Former Director, Madras School of Economics and Economic Consultant to GoTN



Sankarganesh Karuppiah

Indian Revenue Services Officer

Linking benefits to socially desirable outcomes produces broader developmental gains

directly observe incomes for most workers in the informal sector, they rely on proxy indicators such as land ownership, electricity consumption, or household assets. This inevitably produces both inclusion errors (benefits reaching ineligible households) and exclusion errors (eligible households being left out). These targeting errors, whether real or perceived, can impose significant political costs.

The Kalaigarn Magalir Urimai Thittam scheme illustrates this challenge. Although the ruling party at the time promised ₹1,000 per month to all women-headed households before the 2021 election, fiscal constraints led the government to restrict eligibility based on income, land ownership, and other criteria when the scheme was launched in September 2023. Initially, about 1.13 crore women were covered. Following widespread complaints from women who believed they met the eligibility criteria, another 16.94 lakh beneficiaries were added in December 2025. The scheme cost ₹13,807 crore in 2025-26.

Despite the expansion, dissatisfaction persisted. Many women who considered themselves unfairly excluded reportedly became even more aggrieved when eligible beneficiaries received an advance payment of three months' entitlement along with a special summer relief payment. Although the precise electoral impact cannot be measured, even modest shifts in voter preferences can influence outcomes in closely contested constituencies.

These experiences highlight an important

feature of targeted welfare programmes. Political costs arise not only from actual errors but also from perceived ones. Individuals who fail to satisfy official eligibility criteria may nevertheless believe that they have been treated unfairly. Likewise, households that legally qualify may be perceived as undeserving because they appear relatively affluent. Such perceived targeting errors can be as politically consequential as actual administrative mistakes.

This reveals an inherent tension between economics and politics. Economics favours targeted programmes so that scarce public resources reach those most in need. Politics, however, rewards broader inclusion because voters evaluate governments not only by the benefits they receive but also by those they believe were unfairly denied. Consequently, targeted UCT programmes carry an unavoidable political cost.

Conditional cash transfers and other incentive-based welfare programmes offer a more sustainable alternative. Linking benefits to socially desirable outcomes produces broader developmental gains. Tamil Nadu's Midday Meal Scheme illustrates this principle. Since participation depends on school enrolment, self-selection reduces grievances.

The broader lesson is that welfare programmes tied to education or other desirable behaviours can achieve developmental objectives with lower political costs. In contrast, UCTs remain inherently vulnerable to inclusion, exclusion, and perceived targeting errors.

India's unemployment data dilemma

The government has finally found a way to measure the statistical elephant of unemployment; however, it may be incomplete – much like the blind men who touched different parts of a pachyderm and mistook it for the whole truth.

The challenge in measuring the unemployment rate using the Current Weekly Status (CWS) approach – where a person's activity status is determined based on the preceding seven days – is to assess not only whether people are employed, but also the nature of their jobs, the frequency and regularity of their payments, and the overall quality of employment. In an economy where a vast majority of the population are involved in informal work, employment cannot be analysed through a headline rate of high frequency indicator, if it can be called so.

India's decision to transform the quarterly/yearly unemployment data into a monthly indicator is economically desirable, even if its credibility is questionable given the nature of its database, which seldom takes into account circular migration.

Efforts have been made to strengthen India's database comprising EPFO (Employees' Provident Fund Organisation) and ESIC (Employees' State Insurance Corporation) payroll data, GST-based enterprise information, income tax records, corporate payroll data, gig economy employment data, and rural wage indicators but at present, even these sources remain fragmented. Unlike a



Santosh V. Perumal

mature labour market – comprising payroll surveys, unemployment insurance records, formal contracts, and extensive administrative databases – India's large informal employment market is difficult to track.

Most advanced nations count unemployment using a Labour Force Survey based on the definition of the International Labour Organization (ILO). The U.S., Japan, EU and the U.K. have decades of household survey data with detailed information on full-time versus part-time jobs, hourly wages, job duration, labour mobility, and unemployment spells.

A leading indicator

The latest Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS) says that India's unemployment rate for those aged 15 years and above marked a four-month low of 5.1% in July. The review period coincided with the peak of kharif season, when demand for agricultural labour rose for land preparation, transplanting, and allied activities. Since construction, agriculture, small trade, logistics, and local services see seasonal fluctuations, it is likely that July's decline reflects increased hiring in these segments rather than a broad-based expansion in formal sector jobs.

Monthly unemployment should at the best be a leading indicator, not a comprehensive measure of labour market health.

India has a labour market where various reports suggest that 90% of the population are involved in the informal sector; agricultural employment remains seasonal, with wage payments negotiated informally and where

underemployment/disguised employment is widespread. Indicating limited granularity, data is rather sketchy on wage growth, hours worked, job quality, occupational shifts, and sector-wise employment trends. Therefore, monthly unemployment data reflects seasonal movements rather than structural improvement. A fall in unemployment may indicate distress-driven entry into low-productivity jobs rather than genuine employment creation.

The overall decline in unemployment was owing to rural areas, where unemployment declined to 4.5% from 5%; but it should not be read as a major improvement in the job market. Independent labour studies estimate that there are between 30 to 35 million seasonal labourers moving across India annually, forming the invisible backbone of urban construction and infrastructure.

The July data saw an increase in the labour force participation rate, a positive supply-side signal, but stronger investment and job creation prefix sustainable employment recovery. The challenge is to convert this participation into stable, high-productivity jobs.

The revamped PLFS is a significant improvement over earlier low-frequency labour statistics but its success ultimately depends on whether it gauges the reality of the job market – not merely measuring it more frequently. A credible labour market barometer is the need of the hour to capture the livelihoods of millions of workers.

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18 centuries: tracing Smriti Mandhana's journey to the top

With her record-breaking century at the Asia Cup, Smriti Mandhana surpassed Mithali Raj to become the highest run scorer in women's international cricket

DATA POINT

Devvyanshi Bihani

When Smriti Mandhana scored her 18th international century against Hong Kong at the Women's T20 Asia Cup in Dubai on September 3 – in just 57 balls – she set a new record for scoring the highest number of centuries in women's international cricket across all formats. That was not the only record she broke in that match.

By the time she was run out for 124, she had overtaken her former captain Mithali Raj to become the highest run-scorer in women's international cricket. She had taken her career tally to 10,880 runs, 12 more than Mithali's record of 10,868. Her score was also the highest in the history of the Women's T20 Asia Cup, surpassing Chamari Athapaththu's 119 not out from 2024.

Her seven sixes took her career tally to 95, making her the leading six-hitter for India in women's T20Is and the fourth-highest in the world. Smriti also became the first Indian woman to score more than one century in the T20 format, and while doing so, she equalled Mithali's record of 93 fifty-plus scores in international cricket

Mandhana's century-making was a slow burn before it became a sprint. Her international career began with a T20 match against Bangladesh in April 2013, three months before she turned 17. She waited for three years to taste her first century, in her 32nd international innings in 2016 against Australia. But it took 115 more innings and five years to reach her fifth, and another 92 innings to get to 10. Then, the sprint started. Ten of her 18 centuries came within the last two years, and at a notably higher strike rate (**Chart 1**).

Winning streak

That acceleration becomes even more striking when compared

with the other top five century-makers. Australia's Meg Lanning reached 10 hundreds in 123 innings, just about half the number of 239 innings that Smriti took to score hers. All the other four crossed the milestone of 10 before their 200th innings. In contrast, Smriti's performance has soared after she crossed her 200th (**Chart 2**). Of Smriti's 18 centuries, 14 came from ODIs, two in Tests and two in T20Is.

In ODIs, she has scored 5,411 runs with an average of 47.88. In 16 Test innings, she scored 788 with an average of 52.53 and in 167 T20I innings, she scored 4,681 runs with an average of 30.65. Across all three formats, she has 10,880 runs, 75 fifties and an average of 38.86, showing that her record is built on consistency as much as several spectacular peaks.

Moreover, the pace at which she has accumulated her runs really sets her apart.

While she had already become the fastest woman to reach 10,000 runs in just 281 innings, she has now become the highest run scorer in 303 international innings – fewer than the other four players with more than 10,000 runs, all of whom, except Stafanie Taylor, are now retired from international cricket (**Chart 3**).

This pace is reflected in how Smriti clearly stands out with her overall strike rate of 99.57. It is nearly 10 points higher than Suzie, the next fastest among the five. Batting average is the only indicator where she lags among the five, but that too only against her compatriot and inspiration Mithali (**Chart 4**). She is in the same league as the other three.

A few years back, she had said that her mother taught her to persevere – “to go on till reaching the top”. Smriti had also said that she wanted to be the best batter in the world. At just 30, she may have already realised that ambition. But, as she said in the press conference after her records-breaking Hong Kong match, “it is just the start”.

Gearing up for higher peaks

The data for the charts were sourced from Statsguru, the searchable cricket statistics database available at cricinfo.com. All the figures are as of September 4, 2026, when the data was collected

CHART 1: Ten of Smriti's 18 centuries came in the last two years. Her centuries have also been accompanied by a higher strike rate

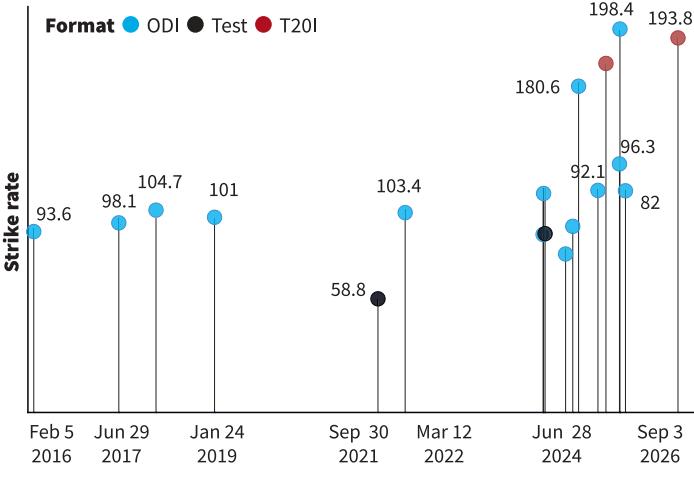


CHART 2: Most of the centuries of the other top scorers came before their 200th innings. Smriti became prolific after crossing her 200th

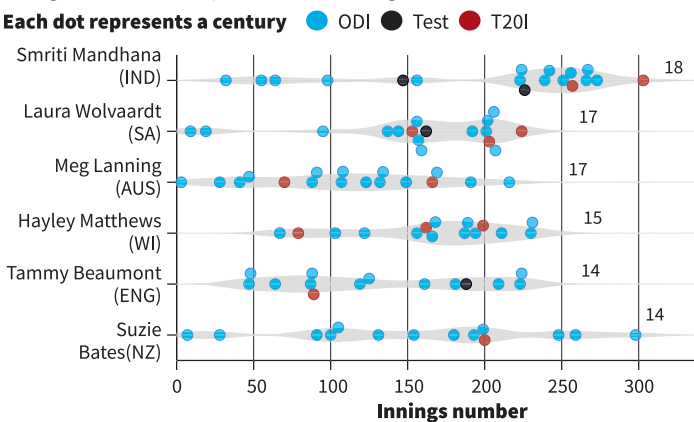


CHART 4: Smriti took fewer innings to become the top scorer with a higher strike rate while Mithali holds the highest average

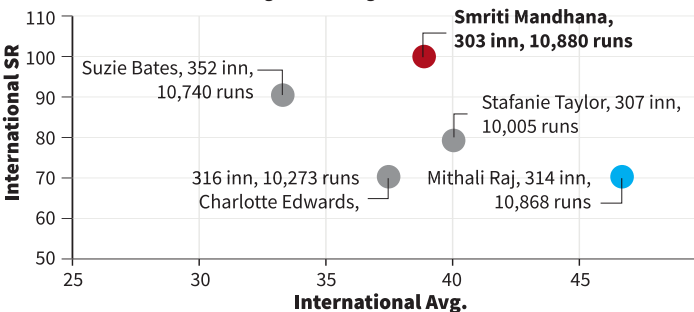
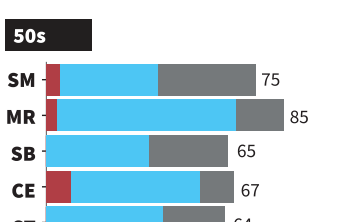
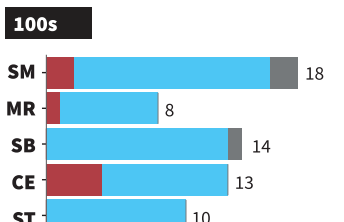
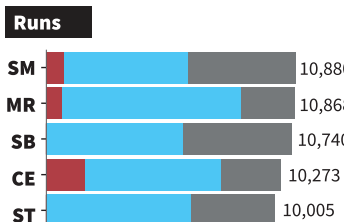
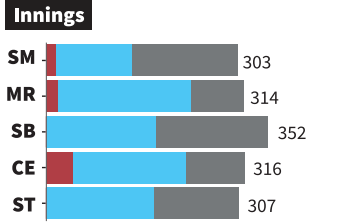


CHART 3: Smriti's innings, runs, centuries, and fifties, in comparison with the other four players who have scored over 10,000 runs in women's international cricket

Mithali Raj - **MR** (IND), Smriti Mandhana - **SM** (IND), Suzie Bates - **SB** (NZ), Charlotte Edwards - **CE** (ENG), Stafanie Taylor - **ST** (WI)

● Test ● ODI ● T20I



FROM THE ARCHIVES

The Hindu

FIFTY YEARS AGO SEPTEMBER 7, 1976

Snake boats to be standardised

Kottayam, September 6: A scheme has been prepared by a Government-sponsored Committee to standardise the snake boat which is the main attraction in the boat races in Kerala.

This Government Committee conducts the Nehru Trophy boat race. The existing boat races are losing their charm because the competing snake boats are of different lengths, and the capacity of rowers differ.

Many of the snake boats in Central Travancore like Pacha, Payipad and Kodupunna can carry between 70 and 80 rowers, while the snake boats like Karichal, Kalooparamban and Jawahar Thayankari can take in over 100 persons. Because of this vast disparity in manpower, the snake boats like Karichal and Kalooparamban alone are now winning the trophies in most of the races. In the light of this, a scheme has been prepared by the Nehru Trophy Boat Race Committee to standardise the snake boats with equal length and strength of rowers.

The Committee is also considering the grant of loans to help this standardisation. According to a tentative scheme, a loan of Rs. 10,000 will be given to each boat.

Four major boat races will be held in various parts of Central Travancore this weekend. The Sree Narayana boat race will be held on September 8, while the Vembanad boat race will be conducted on September 9.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO SEPTEMBER 7, 1926

Railway extension in the Punjab

Lahore, September 6: In accordance with the new policy of railway extension in the Punjab, a reference to which was made by the Governor while inaugurating the Kangra Valley Railway in May last, two other lines Shahdara Narawal and Sirhind Rupar Railways have been sanctioned which are the type of those cross connections to which the Governor referred as being essential for the comfort and convenience of passenger traffic. The first is a line between Lyallpur and Jaranwala, which will pass through the rich tract irrigated by the Lower Chenab Canal. The other will link up Rohtak, Gohana and Panipat forming a direct connection between the Delhi-Ambala line of the North-Western Railway.

M CH-CHE

CPI(M) identifies ‘parliamentary aberrations’, failure to follow mass line as key concerns

Jharkhand Minister and close Soren aide Sudivya Kumar dies

Modi turned student event into political campaign: Kharge

Delhi CM visits collapse site, says won't spare those guilty

Balanced bond portfolio blueprint

Vaishali R. Venkat

It's always easy to buy a bond. A bond can 'promise' regular income but a well-built bond portfolio is a different ball game. It must be able to withstand a default, changing interest rates, and shifting economic conditions. A good portfolio ensures a single issuer's default does not wipe out a large chunk of your investment. The starting point is simple: ask yourself when and how much money you need, whether you want periodic interest or capital appreciation and how much risk you are willing to take: risk tolerance. The answers to these questions will decide the bonds you choose, the lock-in period and if at all you need bonds in the first place.

The spread
Don't let the bond portfolio turn a collection of similar bets. Mix Central and State government securities, Treasury bonds, corporate bonds and bank bonds, and spread the money across issuers, sectors and banks. Government debt can anchor the relatively safer end of the portfolio, while corporate bonds may offer higher yields with a mix of risk and return rather than depend on a single issuer.

Perpetual bonds
Stagger maturities rather than having all bonds mature at the same time. Perpetual bonds have no fixed maturity and can provide regular income but there is no predetermined date for repayment of the principal. They, therefore, need closer scrutiny and are not risk-free.

Interest structure
The interest structure can be diversified too. A portfolio can include zero-coupon bonds, bought at a discount, and pay no periodic interest; alongside fixed-rate, floating-rate and inflation-linked bonds. Convertible bonds offer another option: these hybrid instruments can be converted into a predetermined number of shares of the issuing company.

Credit rating
Before buying, credit rating must be the first warning signal. Higher-rated bonds such as AAA and AA usually carry lower credit risk than BBB, BB or lower-rated bonds. But a rating is no guarantee against loss; read the offer document and assess issuer before investing.

Rebalancing
A bond portfolio needs regular monitoring. Track interest payments, interest rate changes, RBI announcements, developments involving the issuers, and rebalance when allocation drifts from the original plan. Check whether interest payments are made on time, watch out for defaults and track credit ratings. If these alter the risk profile or portfolio's initial allocation, rebalance accordingly. Review it at least every six months or once a year. Finally, track the economy. Stay alert for major economic or political developments that might hit issuers. GDP growth, inflation, joblessness, CPI, WPI, Budget and sectoral performance can impact interest rates and bond prices. Follow these along with developments in Indian/global economy to help understand the forces affecting bond holdings.

No single bond, issuer, maturity or credit rating can suit every investor. The objective is to build a combination that matches need for income, capital protection, liquidity and risk. Remember, higher returns generally come with higher risks and even highly-rated debt is not entirely free from risk. Read the key offer document thoroughly, try to make sense of terms and conditions before investing in bonds. A disciplined approach can help ensure that bonds play their intended role. *(The writer is an NISM & CRISIL-certified Wealth Manager and certified in NISM's Research Analyst module)*

Send queries on personal finance and investing to the moneywise@thehindu.co.in ID. Our experts in personal finance will respond to select queries, but will not give specific recommendations for investment in a particular mutual fund, share or fixed deposit.



ILLUSTRATION: SAAI

Buying insurance at discount? Think twice

In insurance, the cheapest option is not necessarily the one that gives you the best value. Prudence here is not making assumptions but looking at both sides of the bargain.

BETWEEN THE LINES

K. Nitya Kalyani

Buying insurance is commendable. Being a prudent buyer of insurance is even better.

That means more than bargaining for lower premium or looking for more benefits. Insurance is different from most products and services we buy. The price reflects the risks the insurer is taking and the cover and benefits offered. So, when you pay less it is worth asking: what, exactly, am I giving up?

In the previous instalment, we saw how an insured, peeved at not getting a discount on a hospitalisation policy, decided not to renew. This meant losing accrued benefits and importantly, the cover itself.

We all love discounts. There is nothing wrong with wanting the best value from a transaction. The problem arises when we focus on what we save without understanding what we may be giving up.

Consider the experience of a neighbour. The owner of several vehicles, he bought a rugged beast of an SUV. He felt he had earned the right to ask his insurer for a concession. After all, he had been a client for a long time and had several vehicles insured with the company.

The agent obliged with what appeared to be a handsome discount on the

You may be making a saving with a discount but always take a sharp look at what you are no longer getting for that saving

With most products, paying less means getting the same product at a better price if you manage to negotiate well. Insurance does not quite work that way.

motor insurance premium.

A good deal, or so it seemed. Until the SUV faced a dug-up highway, flipped over the median and had to be towed to the dealer's garage. That was when the discount got an entirely different meaning.

The insured found the discounted premium came with a restriction on where the repairs could be done. Repairs at the manufacturer's authorised workshop were not covered under the terms of the discounted policy. Getting the repairs done at a non-network garage could mean delays in getting spare parts, concerns about workmanship and, potentially, implications for manufacturer warranties.

No free lunch

The premium had been reduced but so was the cover. While the restriction was stated in the policy document, the agent did not explicitly tell the client what the discount entailed. The point he missed was: it may be a perfectly legitimate discount, but it may not be a free lunch.

As an aside, buying vehicle cover from the dealer

who also has an authorised garage is a win-win decision as said before in these columns. This way, the claim documentation, estimates, approval, repairs and cashless settlement will all take place seamlessly by the same or closely-related entities.

I recalled a long-ago incident where a premium discount on a home fire policy resulted in the removal of flood cover. Chennai, as we know, is no stranger to floods, sometimes with tragic consequences. Luckily, since 2021, flood cover has been inbuilt with a single bundled premium following an IRDAI stipulation.

Claims too

While you have to be careful about discounts when buying or renewing insurance, claims can be fraught too. When a wind-shield breaks, the damage may be covered by motor insurance. But making a claim for a replacement, costing about ₹8,000, could mean no-claim bonus (NCB) is cut by one slab at least. With some insurers it disappears totally.

If you had accumulated

the maximum NCB of 50% of the own-damage premium, losing it could mean paying substantially more at renewal. The claim may be admissible, but is it worth making?

With most products, paying less means generally getting the same product at a better price if you manage to negotiate well. Insurance does not quite work that way. The premium is a price for a particular bundle of risks, conditions, exclusions and benefits. Change the bundle and the price can change too.

Knowing changes

Before accepting a lower premium, ask what has changed. Has an add-on been removed? Has a deductible been introduced or increased? Do you have co-pay now? Has a particular facility or service, like cashless claims, been restricted? Has the choice of repairer or hospital been limited? Has some other condition changed?

You may be making a saving, but take a sharp look at what you are no longer getting for that saving. In insurance, the cheapest option is not necessarily the one that gives you the best value. Prudence here is not making assumptions but looking at both sides of the bargain.

The discount may be real. The cost of the discount may simply show up later.

(The writer is a business journalist specialising in insurance & corporate history.)

Bank Fixed Deposit Rates

Bank Name	Interest Rates (%)			
	Highest Slab	1-year Tenure	3-year Tenure	5-year Tenure
Small Finance Banks				
AU Small Finance Bank	7.40	6.35	7.40	6.75
Equitas Small Finance Bank	8.00	7.10	7.10	7.00
ESAF Small Finance Bank	8.00	6.00	6.00	5.75
Jana Small Finance Bank	8.00	7.00	8.00	7.77
Shivalik Small Finance Bank	8.00	6.00	7.50	6.25
slice Small Finance Bank	7.75	6.25	7.50	7.00
Suryoday Small Finance Bank	8.25	7.25	7.25	8.25
Ujjivan Small Finance Bank	7.80	7.25	7.25	7.20
Utkarsh Small Finance Bank	8.10	6.00	7.50	7.00
Private Sector Banks				
Axis Bank	6.50	6.25	6.50	6.50
Bandhan Bank	7.45	7.00	7.25	5.85
City Union Bank	7.25	6.65	6.50	6.55
CSB Bank	7.10	5.00	5.75	5.75
DBS Bank	6.85	6.30	6.40	6.25
DCB Bank	7.50	6.90	7.00	7.50
Federal Bank	6.70	6.25	6.50	6.40
HDFC Bank	6.50	6.25	6.45	6.40
ICICI Bank	6.50	6.25	6.45	6.50
IDFC FIRST Bank	7.10	6.50	7.10	6.75
IndusInd Bank	7.00	6.75	7.00	6.65

Bank Name	Interest Rates (%)			
	Highest Slab	1-year Tenure	3-year Tenure	5-year Tenure
Jammu & Kashmir Bank				
IDBI Bank	6.50	6.20	6.35	6.25
Karnataka Bank	7.00	6.50	6.15	6.15
Kotak Mahindra Bank	6.80	6.35	6.40	6.25
RBL Bank	7.20	7.00	7.20	6.70
SBM Bank India	7.30	7.10	7.10	7.00
South Indian Bank	6.80	6.25	6.20	5.70
Tamilnad Mercantile Bank	7.25	6.80	6.70	6.70
YES Bank	7.25	6.65	7.00	6.75
Public Sector Banks				
Bank of Baroda	6.75	6.25	6.25	6.30
Bank of India	6.85	6.50	6.70	6.00
Bank of Maharashtra	6.65	6.40	5.25	5.00
Canara Bank	6.60	6.25	6.25	6.25
Central Bank of India	6.75	6.10	6.00	6.00
Indian Bank	6.65	6.10	6.05	6.00
Indian Overseas Bank	6.60	6.50	6.10	6.10
Punjab National Bank	6.60	6.25	6.30	6.35
Punjab & Sind Bank	6.85	5.85	5.85	5.95
State Bank of India	6.45	6.25	6.30	6.05
Union Bank of India	6.55	6.20	6.10	6.00

Home Loan Interest Rates

Name of Lender	Loan Amount (Rs.)		
	Upto 30 lakh	Above 30 lakh & upto 75 lakh	Above 75 lakh
(In %)			
Public Sector Banks			
Bank of Baroda	7.20-9.00	7.20-9.00	7.20-9.25
Bank of India	7.10-10.00	7.10-10.00	7.10-10.25
Bank of Maharashtra	7.00-9.90	7.00-9.90	7.00-9.90
Central Bank of India	7.10-9.15	7.10-9.15	7.10-9.15
Indian Bank	7.15-9.15	7.15-9.15	7.15-9.15
Indian Overseas Bank	7.20 #	7.20 #	7.20 #
Punjab and Sind Bank	7.35-10.75	7.35-10.75	7.35-10.75
Punjab National Bank	7.30-9.30	7.25-9.20	7.25-9.20
State Bank of India	7.25-8.55	7.25-8.55	7.25-8.55
UCO Bank*	7.15-9.25	7.15-9.25	7.15-9.25
Private Sector Banks			
Axis Bank	8.00-11.90	8.00-11.90	8.00 - 9.10
Bandhan Bank	8.55 - 13.52	8.55 - 13.52	8.55 - 13.52
City Union Bank	8.25-9.50	8.50-10.00	8.75-10.50
CSB Bank	8.30 #	8.30 #	8.30 #
Federal Bank	8.35 - 10.50	7.35 - 10.50	7.35 - 9.50
HDFC Bank	7.75 #	7.75 #	7.75 #
HSBC Bank	7.45 #	7.45 #	7.45 #
ICICI Bank	7.55 #	7.55 #	7.55 #

Name of Lender	Loan Amount (Rs.)		
	Upto 30 lakh	Above 30 lakh & upto 75 lakh	Above 75 lakh
(In %)			
Karnataka Bank			
Karur Vysya Bank	7.48- 11.80	7.48- 11.80	7.48- 11.80
Kotak Mahindra Bank	8.50-10.65	8.50-10.65	8.50-10.65
RBL Bank	7.60 #	7.60 #	7.60 #
South Indian Bank	9.00 #	9.00 #	9.00 #
Tamilnad Mercantile Bank	7.25 #	7.25 #	7.25 #
Housing Finance Companies (HFCs)			
Aditya Birla Capital	7.90 - 9.30	7.90 - 9.30	7.90 - 9.30
Bajaj Housing Finance	7.75 #	7.75 #	7.75 #
GIC Housing Finance	7.25 #	7.25 #	7.25 #
Godrej Housing Finance	8.20 #	8.20 #	8.20 #
ICICI Home Finance	7.65 #	7.65 #	7.65 #
LIC Housing Finance	7.50 #	7.50 #	7.50 #
PNB Housing Finance	7.15 #	7.15 #	7.15 #
Sammaan Capital	7.75-10.05%	7.60-10.05%	7.50-9.95
SMFG India Home Finance	8.75 #	8.75 #	8.75 #
Tata Capital	9.25 #	9.25 #	9.25 #
*Extra concession of 0.05% & 0.10% for women borrowers/takeover loans respectively Rates as on September 2 #onwards Source:Paisabazaar.com			

Gold and silver rise

PRECIOUSMETALS

Short-term trend in gold and silver have turned positive post the breakout of key resistance level; the trend would remain positive until the support level is breached

B.Krishnakumar

Breaking the downtrend of several months, precious metals recovered sharply in August. The expectations around interest rate hike by the U.S. Federal Reserve played a key role in influencing the prices. The weakening of the U.S. Dollar too helped precious metals stage a recovery in August.

Comex gold gained 9.73 % in August to settle at \$4,497.3/ounce by month end. Comex silver posted an even better performance gaining 16.32% to settle at \$67.2/ounce.

Gain in local markets

Mirroring global market trend, the precious metal prices settled higher in the local markets too. The gains were, however curtailed by Indian Rupee strengthening against the U.S. Dollar.

MCX Gold gained 7.75% to settle at ₹1,54,456/10 gm. MCX Silver, too, closed on strong note at ₹2,40,250/kg, a 8.46% gain last month.

Comex gold price managed to breakout above the resistance level of \$4,410 mentioned last month. In line with last month's observation, the price later moved to the target zone of \$4,650-\$4,700. The short-term outlook for gold has turned positive and the price could head to the next target at \$4,750-\$4,800.

The positive outlook for Comex gold would be under threat only if the price falls below the support at the \$4,200-\$4,220 zone. Until this zone is breached, expect the gold price to head to the target mentioned above.

Similar to gold, Comex silver price, too, staged a breakout above the resistance level of \$66. The short-term outlook as a result has turned positive. The price could now head to the immediate target zone of \$72-\$74. The positive outlook would be valid as long as the price stays above the support level at \$62.5.

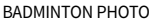
MCX gold price, too, crossed above resistance level at ₹1,49,000 and later scaled a high of ₹1,64,773 on August 24 before receding a bit in the past few days. The short-term outlook has turned positive and the price could head to ₹1,66,000-₹1,68,000 zone. The positive outlook would invalidate if the price drops below ₹1,48,000.

Similar to gold, the trend in MCX silver price has turned positive after the price moved past the resistance level of ₹2,45,000. As long as the price stays above ₹2,25,000, the price could move to next target zone of ₹2,56,000-₹2,59,000.

To summarise, the short-term trend in both gold and silver have turned positive post the breakout of key resistance level. The trend would remain positive until the support level mentioned above is breached.

(The author is a Chennai-based analyst/trader. Views, opinions in this column are based on an analysis of short-term price movement in gold and silver futures at COMEX & Multi Commodity Exchange of India. This is not a trading or investment advice.)

We always perform well at the China Masters, says Satwiksairaj



Yuki and Anirudh fail to clear first round in US Open doubles



I felt like I couldn't play tennis: Keys on her third-set implosion



‘We put on a show and it took everything to get through that’



Third time's the charm for Satwik-Chirag pair

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Arsenal delivers statement fightback; Barca coasts

Olympiad crucial for Gukesh, says MVL

MVL has his own World championship to look forward to as he is part of the pilot edition of the newly launched Total Chess World Championship Tour.

INBRIEF



FIFA confirms Infantino will run in presidential election

Gianni Infantino will stand in March's FIFA presidential election despite the backlash over his now-abandoned plan to bring private investment into the World Cup. Football's global governing body made the confirmation on Sunday. "The FIFA president announced in April that he will stand for re-election in 2027," a FIFA spokesperson said. Infantino had declined to answer questions about his future as he arrived for the opening of the women's U-20 World Cup in Poland.

Mansi finishes runner-up at Indonesia Masters Super 100

Indian shuttler Mansi Singh finished runner-up at the Indonesia Masters Super 100 badminton after going down 16-21, 8-21 to China's Xu Wen Jing in the women's singles final in Jakarta on Sunday. The world No. 76 Indian had defeated Canada's Rachel Chan, while Xu beat third seed Anmol Kharb in the semifinals.

A special hundred for Shreyas Gopal and a memorable effort from Shikhar

S. Dipak Ragav
CHENNAI

On a day when he made his 100th First Class appearance during the Duleep Trophy final, South Zone leggie Shreyas Gopal felt he was happy to prove a point that wrist-spinners can have a long career.

"I was told that there are not too many leg-spinners who have played 30-50 games. I wanted to show that leg-spinners can play red-ball cricket and still be successful. I put a lot of work into my bowling," said Shreyas on Sunday.

The 33-year-old had one of his best years in the Ranji Trophy last season, claiming 48 wickets and scoring 469 runs, playing a key role in Karnataka reaching the final.

"I think it's just tactically trying to get a little better. Using the crease, understanding the situation and when to attack, when to defend," he explained on the areas he has improved.



Pulling his weight: Shikhar made a fluent 85 on the opening day. R. RAGU

"Most times it would come off. Sometimes, like today, it won't come off. But as long as you go in with a plan, it actually gives you a sense of direc-

tion," he said. Last year, Shreyas also led Mangaluru Dragons to title triumph in the Maharaja Trophy KSCA T20 tournament and felt his

AROUND THE CITY

BNC makes it a hat-trick of titles

Besant Nagar Club (BNC) lifted the RWD Rolling Trophy for the third consecutive year when it defeated Gandhi Nagar Club-A 48-23 in the final of the third RWD Open Chennai City Club league-cum-knockout tennis championship at the SDAT Tennis Stadium, Nungambakkam here on Sunday. The BNC team comprising Vijay Kannan, Ajai Selvaraj, Nihal Kapoor and Uday Kumar Reddy was ably supported by veterans Ramprasad Reddy and Lingam. BNC received ₹1 lakh from chief guest Mohammed Riaz, former Indian hockey team captain. Also present were W.S. Habib,

chairman & managing director, RWD and B. Venkatesh, secretary of the Tamil Nadu Tennis Association.

TNCA u-14 trials

The Tamil Nadu Cricket Association will conduct open selection trials for boys in the under-14 category for the forthcoming domestic season from September 21 to 24 at the MAC 'B' nets. Players born on or after September 1, 2012, and on or before August 31, 2014, are eligible to participate. They may register online through the link available at www.tnca.in. Online registration opens at 10 a.m. on September 7 and closes at 6 p.m. on September 14.

Modric available for Croatia in Nations League

Agencies
ZAGREB

Croatia's veteran midfielder and captain Luka Modric will stay with the squad in the forthcoming Nations League matches, the national football federation announced on Saturday.

Modric, who will turn 41 on Wednesday, confirmed to coach Slaven Bilic and HNS head Marijan Kustic that he remains available to the Croatian national team.

SNAPSHOTS

Werro wins with a meet record

BRUSSELS: In-form Swiss Audrey Werro was forced into a dip for victory in the 800m while newly minted World record holders Masai Russell and Alison dos Santos also raced to meet records on the second and final day of the Diamond League finals on Saturday. Werro, 22, dipped for the line after a tight final 200 metres for victory in 1m 54.75s. Russell delivered in the final 50 metres to win the 100m hurdles in 12.20s. Dos Santos led from gun-to-tape in the men's 400m hurdles. The Brazilian timed 46.70s to obliterate the meet's previous best of 47.51 set by American Andre Phillips back in 1986. Kenny Bednarek equalled his own world lead of 19.62s when winning the 200m. And Jamaica's Tina Clayton wrapped up the 100m in 10.92s. China's Ziyi Yan dominated the women's javelin with a best of 68.42m before Jamaica's Rajindra Campbell set a National record of 23.08m, a world leading mark, in the men's



Danny Meitei. X@INDIANFOOTBALL

shot put. There was a shock in the women's 1,500m as Poland's Klaudia Kazimierska clocked a National record and world lead of 3:54.05, smashing Faith Kipyegon's meet record by a huge 0.70s. Ramesh Tharanga Pathirage became the first Sri Lankan to become a Diamond League champion by winning the men's javelin with a best of 89.04m.

India qualifies for under-20 Asian Cup
TASHKENT: India qualified for the AFC under-20 Asian Cup after 20 years. The Blue Colts registered a 3-0 win over Bangladesh in their final Group B qualifier at the Do'stlik

Stadium on Sunday. The victory took India to six points. Uzbekistan's 3-0 win over Syria later in the day ensured India finished second in Group B and qualified as one of the seven-best runners-up across the eight groups. Uzbekistan topped the group with nine points while Syria ended up third with a tally of three.

India junior men rally for a draw; women swamp Malaysia

MOQI (CHINA): The Indian men's hockey team showed tremendous grit to rally and secure a 3-3 draw against Japan in its second Pool A match of the Junior Asia Cup on Sunday. The women's team, meanwhile, consolidated its position at the top of the points table with an 11-1 hammering of Malaysia in its Elite Pool match.

The results: Men: India 3 (Anmol Ekka 4, 60, Ashu Maurya 10) drew with Japan 3 (Ryushin Sasaki 11, Kazuki Nakanishi 48, 59). **Women:** India 11 (Puja Sahoo 1, 42, Purnima Yadav 4, 17, Binima Dhan 8, Krishna Sharma 14, Sukhveer Kaur 21, Geeta Yadav 28, 53, Sanika Chandrakant Mane 43, 58) bt Malaysia 1 (Nur Mohd 38).

Winfield should score an encore in Khammam Plate

HYDERABAD: The five-year-old mare Winfield, who won well in her last start, should score an encore in the Khammam Plate, the chief event of Monday's (Sept. 7) races.

1 CHAITANYA CHAKRAM PLATE (1,400m, (Terms) Maiden, 3-y-o only (Cat. II), 2.10 p.m.: 1. French Lieutenant (4) Antony Raj 56, 2. Mantle Plume (II) Akshay K 56, 3. Ashwa Jaffna (7) Gaurav 54.5, 4. Belgium Waffle (8) Mohit 54.5, 5. Classy Touch (2) Neeraj 54.5, 6. Costa Mesa (5) Kuldeep Sr. 54.5, 7. Evansville (9) P. Sai K 54.5, 8. Khamagani (6) B. Nikhil 54.5, 9. Kinship (10) D.S. Deoraj 54.5, 10. Menlo Park (1) Abhay Singh 54.5 and 11. Night Whisper (3) A.A. Vikrant 54.5.

1. FRENCH LIEUTENANT, 2. ASHWA JAFFNA, 3. MANTLE PLUME

2 KHAMMAM PLATE (1,800m) (Terms), 3-y-o and upward, 2.45: 1. Gold Empire (4) A.A. Vikrant 61, 2. Truth (7) Imran Chisty 59, 3. Nonpareil (6) Akshay K 57.5, 4. Winfield (1) Antony Raj 55, 5. Get Lucky (8) Md. Ekram 53.5, 6. Shadow Of The Moon (2) Afroz K 53.5, 7. N R I Superpower (3) Ajay K 52 and 8. Secret Saint (5) Abhay Singh 52.

1. WINFIELD, 2. NONPAREIL, 3. GET LUCKY

3 MAHABUBNAGAR PLATE (Div. I) (1,200m), 5-y-o and upward, rated 60 to 85 (Cat. II), 3.20: 1. Viv-aldo (5) B. Nikhil 62, 2. Knight Crusader (4) B.R. Kumar 58, 3. Decoy (7) Shivam 57.5, 4. Darling's Boy (9) P. Ajeeth K 56, 5. Annhilator (6) Akshay K 55.5, 6. Azrinaz (3) A.A. Vikrant 55, 7. Star Forever (8) P. Sai K 55, 8. Detective (1) Gaurav 54, 9. Glorious Power (10) M.S. Deora 52.5 and 10. Torchbearer (2) Kuldeep Jr. 51.

1. ANNHILATOR, 2. KNIGHT CRUSADER, 3. DECOY

4 MANCHERIAL PLATE (1,600m), 5-y-o and upward, rated 20 to 45 (Cat. III), 3.55: 1. Bold Beauty (4) Md. Ismail 60.5, 2. Take A Breath (7) Rafique Sk. 60.5, 3. Sunny Day (2) P. Ajeeth K 59.5, 4. Only My Way (6) Afroz K 58, 5. Silver Arrow (8) A.A. Vikrant 58, 6. Hoping High (5) Mohit 53.5, 7. Secret Option (1) Akshay K 52.5 and 8. Shubhraj (3) Surya Prakash 52.

1. SECRET OPTION, 2. TAKE A BREATH, 3. HOPING HIGH

5 BHADRACHALAM TROPHY (1,200m), 3-y-o and upward, rated 40 to 65 (Cat. II), 4.30: 1. Dubai Touch (13) M.S. Deora 60, 2. Dyanoosh (6) Md. Ekram 59.5, 3. Warwick (3) P. Ajeeth K 59.5, 4. See The Light (II) B.R. Kumar 58.5, 5. Clara (12) Imran Chisty 57, 6. Kalki (10) Surya Prakash 56.5, 7. Pole Star (8) Akshay K 55, 8. Flying Fury (7) G. Nareesh 54, 9. Dashing Charm (5) Kuldeep Jr. 53.5, 10. Sangreal (2) P. Sai K 53.5, 11. Sharanga (9) Abhay Singh 53.5, 12. Colt Pistol (1) Rafique Sk. 51 and 13. Calabasas (4) Ajay K 50.5.

1. WARWICK, 2. SEE THE LIGHT, 3. POLE STAR

the accelerator and brought up his century in style, driving Shreyas Gopal down the ground majestically.

Alongside his Jharkhand teammate Kumar Kushagra (63 batting, 75b, 4x4, 5x6), the duo added an unbroken 144 runs for the fifth wicket as East established an early hold on the contest.

The scores: East Zone — 1st innings: Abhimanyu Easwaran run out 72, Vaibhav Sooryavanshi c sub (Tanay) b Milind 44, Shikhar Mohan b Milind 85, Sudip Kumar Gharami c Milind b Vijay 6, Ishan Kishan (batting) 111, Kumar Kushagra (batting) 63; Extras (nb-4): 4; Total (for four wkts. in 79 overs): 385.

Fall of wickets: 1-100, 2-133, 3-147, 4-241.

South Zone bowling: Siraj 14-1-96-0, Nidheesh 10-2-39-0, Vijay 22-3-114-1, Milind 13-1-56-2, Shreyas 19-3-77-0, Rasheed 1-0-3-0.

Toss: East.

SHOOTING

Uthra Ganesan
BHOPAL

Going for his second Asian Games, 22-year-old Rudranksh Balasaheb Patil is a far cry from the teenager who took to the firing station in Hangzhou. It's been only three years but the period since then has seen the shy, nerdy and overthinking kid grow into a more assured, relaxed and quietly confident person.

"Excitement," he declared when asked what was the predominant feeling. The Indian pistol and rifle shooters have gathered here for a short preparatory camp starting Sunday before leaving on the 14th for Nagoya.

Rudranksh, the only Indian male shooter who will participate in two events, is not bothered with the responsibility, challenge or expectations of managing both.

The 10m air rifle and the



Motivated: Rudranksh says the aim is gold, and that his hunger to win is unabated. R.V. MOORTHY

50m 3 Position are completely different and come with their own set of challenges. Rudranksh, though, insists it isn't impossible. "I am getting to participate in two events and I am able to see that all the hard work which I have put in is paying off," he told *The Hindu*.

"This is the first Asian Games and fourth international competition in which I will compete in two events. Every time I have improved a little bit. I have

second thoughts about and lofting down the ground for a six and a four. The southpaw eventually holed out on the leg-side trying to pull C.V. Milind for 44.

At the other end, Abhimanyu kept pace with the youngster and did not hold himself back, be it pulling Siraj effortlessly or giving the charge to the spinners.

Post lunch, Shikhar and Kishan combined forces, adding 94 for the fourth wicket, capitalising on a below-par effort from the South bowlers.

Shikhar was largely untroubled, confidently driving Siraj for back-to-back boundaries through the off-side before launching off-spinner T. Vijay for a six and two boundaries off consecutive deliveries.

Kishan kept busy without trying to be aggressive, bringing up his half-century off 71 deliveries. In the final session, he pressed on



The graceful artist’s brush with history

It was only fitting that Smriti’s record-breaking stroke, in India’s Asia Cup match against Hong Kong, came on the off-side. It was not just her former India captain that she moved ahead of on account of her 64-ball 124. She also took the record for the most hundreds in women’s international cricket from Australian legend Meg Lanning

P.K. Ajith Kumar

Smriti Mandhana danced down the track. She launched into Ruchitha Venkatesh, and sent the hapless off-spinner over wide long-off.

The six took her past fellow-Indian Mithali Raj, making her the leading scorer of runs in international women’s cricket.

It was only fitting that her record-breaking stroke, in India’s Asia Cup match against Hong Kong China at the Dubai International Cricket Stadium last Thursday, came on the off-side. She is, after all, the goddess on the off-side.

It was not just her former India captain that Smriti moved ahead of on account of her 64-ball 124. She also took the record for the most hundreds in women’s international cricket from Australian legend Meg Lanning, who retired at the age of 31, and South Africa captain Laura Wolvaardt (17 each).

Lanning and Mithali were the two outstanding batters in women’s cricket. Ian Bishop had once said, Lanning was one of the very few players, male or female, that he would stop whatever he was doing just to watch her bat. And she is regarded by many, including the great Charlotte Edwards, as the greatest female cricketer of all time.

But for Mithali, humble and amiable off the field and ruthless on it, girls like Smriti would not have had an idol to look up to in India.

Until a decade ago, Mithali was the main reason why people in the country were aware of the existence of women’s cricket in India. She would score big runs with remarkable regularity and force her way into the sports pages.

Women’s cricket in India may be big now with big money, but for a long time it was the runs of Mithali and the wickets of Jhulan Goswami, along with thankless efforts from their teammates and their predecessors as well as the sacrifices of a man called Mahendra Kumar Sharma (an organiser who sold his property so that he could fund women’s cricket), that kept the sport alive.

Mithali and Jhulan are a bit unlucky in that their careers ended a year before the WPL began. They deserved to be part of the most glamorous and lucrative league in women’s cricket.

Smriti has certainly been lucky. Or cricket fans have been lucky. The WPL has played a major role in widening the fanbase of women’s cricket considerably. So a lot more people have been able to enjoy the sheer artistry of Smriti’s batting.

Make no mistake, there is no one in women’s cricket that gives as much joy. Yes, Wolvaardt has her own fans, and her cover drive is perfection; it is one of the greatest sights in cricket. And yet, Smriti is in a league of her own. When she gets going, you know why sport, at the highest level, is able to compete with art. The thing with Smriti is that even when she isn’t at her best, she can look good enough.

One recalls her speaking at a press

K.R. DEEPAK



conference about how she felt she wasn’t exactly at her best, after playing a big knock and some lovely strokes. That was the perfectionist in her speaking. A real artist is like that.

While the artistry in her batting may be a gift, her phenomenal success is something she has worked hard for. When she was little, her mother asked her to reach the top of whatever activity she chose for herself. She followed that advice.

Look at the way she is getting better and better. She is scoring faster, and she is converting far better, too. She has of late been hitting more hundreds in international cricket than she used to: last year alone, she made six of them.

Breathtaking

One of those hundreds gave India an excellent chance of pulling off a most unlikely chase against Australia. The Aussie women had made 412, and that too, without even batting for the full 50 overs at New Delhi. That was 111 more than the successful chase in a Women’s ODI at the time (since then India and New Zealand have set new records).

That night in Delhi, Beth Mooney, with a brilliant 75-ball 138, seemed to have batted India out of the match, but Smriti was in no mood to go down without a fight. Her breathtaking 125 off 63 balls raised India’s hopes. One recalls, while watching the match from the media box, going back to the scorecard of that incredible men’s ODI between South Africa and Australia at Johannesburg in



brother Shravan, who played for the Maharashtra junior team, that she wanted to become a cricketer. Rahul Dravid had presented her a bat through him.

Smriti played with that bat during her India debut against Bangladesh in the final T20I at the Reliance Stadium in Vadodara in 2013. Later that year, in the same Gujarat city, she scored a stunning 224 off 150 balls for Maharashtra against Gujarat in a West Zone under-19 one-day game at the Alembic ground. That innings was one of the early signs of her extraordinary talent.

She was 17 then.

Thirteen years later, she holds two of the most significant all-time records in women’s cricket. In fact, after her record-breaking innings, she said: “It is just the start, I would say.”

She admitted: “Going past the international record of the centuries, I mean, 18 is a good number to go past, firstly I will say that. But again, two of the legends of women’s cricket, Meg Lanning and Mithali Raj. Genuinely, these are the two people who I have grown up watching a lot of my cricket, tried to take a lot of things from them as batters. So I am really happy that I could go past them in whatever way.”

Smriti will continue to spread happiness wherever she goes. Her batting is like that. Little wonder, her fans are spread across different countries, be it England or Australia. She is hugely popular in the leagues she plays there.

She has also earned a lot of respect from her peers or former stars. When they speak about the batters they enjoy watching, it is Smriti that they often talk about first.

Former England batter Mark Butcher and former Sri Lankan quick Ramesh Ratnayake have said Smriti reminded them of David Gower. W.V. Raman, former India opener who has also worked with her as the coach of the National team, has compared her to Sourav Ganguly.

Of course, Ganguly and Gower were among the most stylish players of their generations. At the moment, few batters could give the connoisseurs of cricket as much pleasure as Smriti.

At 30, there is plenty of cricket left in her yet. So the cricket fans can look forward to more delightful innings from her. She may be the world’s best batter, but that doesn’t mean that she cannot try to get better. During the Women’s T20 World Cup in England recently, when she had an opportunity to chat with former Australian opener Matthew Hayden, she sought tips on batting from him.

Smriti remains committed to her art as ever.

THE GIST

While the artistry in her batting may be a gift, her phenomenal success is something she has worked hard for

When she was little, her mother asked her to reach the top of whatever activity she chose for herself. She followed that advice

Beth Mooney, with a brilliant 75-ball 138, seemed to have batted India out of the match in Delhi, but Smriti was in no mood to go down without a fight

The stylish opener was batting as if she was in a dream. As long as she was at the wicket, the 413-run target was going to be reachable

Smriti will continue to spread happiness wherever she goes. Her batting is like that. Little wonder, her fans are spread across different countries, be it England or Australia. She is hugely popular in the leagues she plays there

Sharpest pictures of sun’s surface reveal previously unseen whirlpools

In all pictures taken of the sun’s surface in the past century, the edges of its convection cells were blurred; for decades, solar physicists wondered if these edges were really frayed or if they could find more detail if they observed the cells using a more powerful telescope; new images have settled the debate

Shamim Haque Mondal

Scientists have used the world’s largest telescope to study the sun to capture the highest-resolution pictures yet of the sun’s surface, revealing small, violent plasma whirlpools moving across it.

The discovery could change how scientists understand the way energy and magnetic fields move through the sun’s atmosphere. These whirlpools seem like an efficient way to move energy and magnetic flux, and could also be responsible for braiding the sun’s magnetic fields at small scales.

Such braided fields are thought to store and release the energy that powers solar flares and other eruptions – and may help explain why the sun’s outer atmosphere is so unexpectedly hot.

The team’s findings were published in *Nature* on August 5.

Details on the edge

The part of the sun that we see is called the photosphere. This is a chaotic environment filled with a roiling mass of superheated plasma. The light we see on the earth is energy emitted by this plasma.

Astronomers have been taking pictures of the sun’s exterior for a long time, and they have always seen a beehive-like structure there. The cells in this structure are called convection cells. Each cell spans up to around 2,000 km – the distance from Mumbai to Guwahati – and lasts for 5-10 minutes before dissipating. The visible features of a convection cell are called granules. All these granules together form the outer visible layer of the sun.

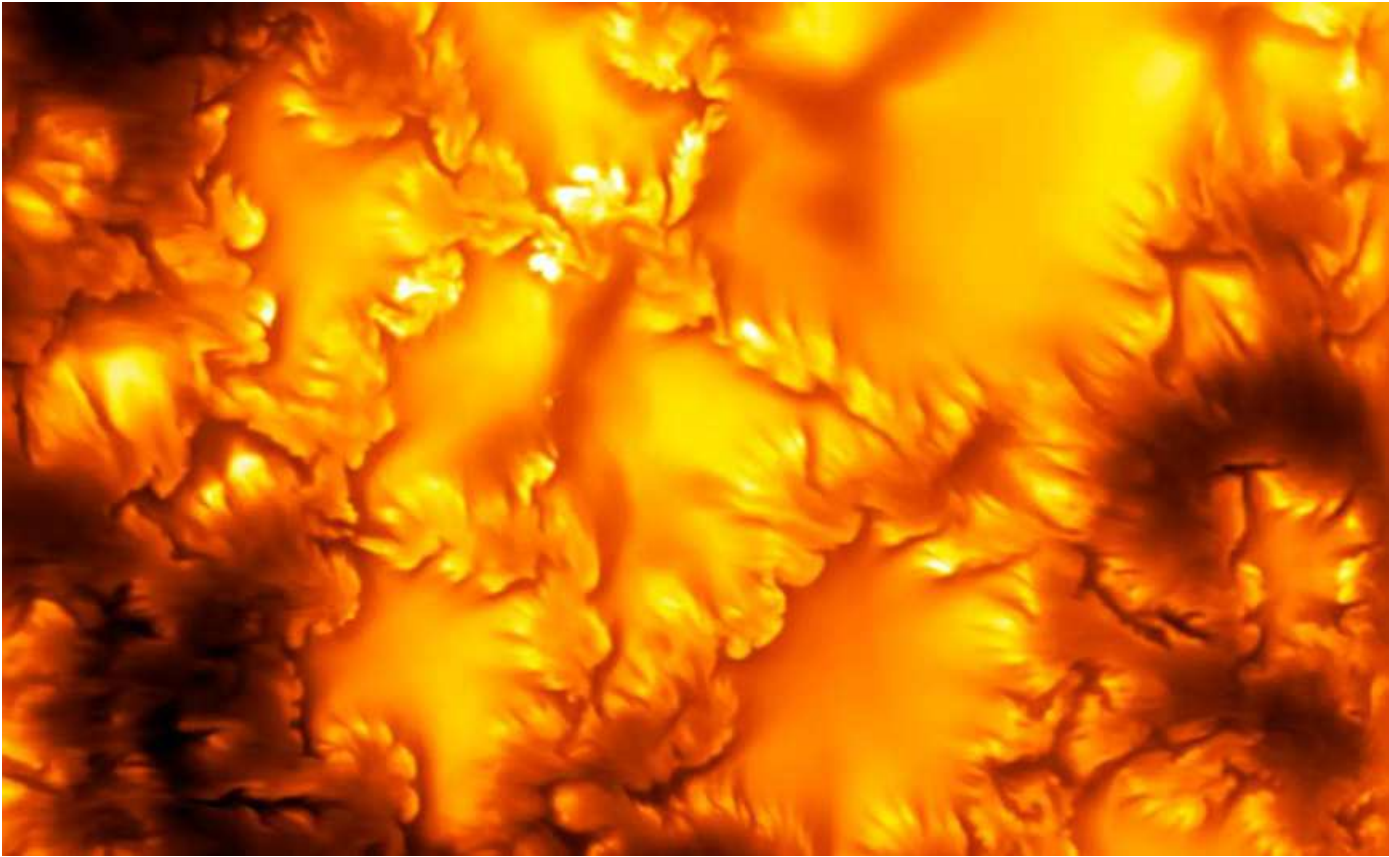
In all the pictures taken of the sun’s surface in the past century, the edges of these granules were blurred. They looked like frayed cotton.

And for decades, solar physicists have wondered if these edges are really frayed or if they will find more detail if they observe them using a more powerful telescope. The new images have settled the debate.

“The weakness is in the telescope’s aperture,” the researchers – from the U.S. National Science Foundation National Solar Observatory (NSO), Germany’s Max Planck Institute for Solar System Research (MPS), and the High Altitude Observatory (HAO) – wrote in their paper in *Nature*.

It seems that with telescopes whose primary mirrors are smaller than two metres wide, it is not possible for physicists to observe the fundamental perturbations on the sun’s surface.

For their study, the researchers turned to the NSF Daniel K. Inouye Solar Telescope (DKIST) in Hawaii. Perched



The highest-resolution image of the sun’s surface ever captured, by the Daniel K. Inouye Solar Telescope. At the edges of the solar granules, the image reveals fringed-looking structures that display swirling motions. NSF/NSO/AURA/MPS

near the 10,000-foot-high summit of the Haleakalā volcano, the DKIST features a giant four metres primary mirror. It started scientific operations in late 2019.

The team used it to observe a magnetically active region on the sun called NOAA 14060, capturing light at a wavelength of 416 nanometres (which is visible light of a blue-violet colour). They also paired the telescope with a high-speed FastCam camera developed jointly by NSO and MPS. The camera had a exposure time of 100 microseconds, capturing up to 740 frames per second.

With the help of this camera, the researchers took many pictures of the sun’s turbulent atmosphere.

Then, one member of the research team, Michiel van Noort of MPS, used an advanced image processing technology called multi-frame blind deconvolution to remove the blurring that occurs when the sun is photographed from the earth. Then the team combined multiple cleaned-up images to recover a clear image.

Dr. Noort used this technology to capture images of the sun’s surface of dimension 5,800 km x 4,350 km at a resolution of 19 km. This is like being able to spot a 10-rupee coin in Mumbai from Pune. Thus, the team found that the edges of the solar granules are innumerable small coils of plasma, each only 25-170 km long, separated by around

65 km. And they had their own little magnetic fields.

Wind over a river

The researchers also found that these small plasma coils moved along the boundaries of the granules, twisting and interacting with one another. And as they did, they generated whirlpools in the plasma – vortices that spun rapidly and changed shape within seconds.

When a strong wind blows over a calm river, small whirlpools form on the water. Generally, physicists say, a vortex is formed at the interface where two adjacent fluids move past each other at different speeds. The same thing has been found happening on the sun.

Scientists have previously found such whirlpools in the atmosphere of gaseous planets like Jupiter.

This is the first time scientists have seen such a wave moving on the surface of the sun.

These whirlpools in the sun’s plasma also rapidly grow in size. The scientists found that the fastest-growing vortices became 2.7-times larger than their original size in just 18 seconds. Even those that grew a little slower took only 71 seconds to reach this size. They rotated at about 1.6-2.8 km/s.

The scientists found that, over three minutes, these whirlpools constantly

form, merge with each other, and break up again.

A new way

The team confirmed its observations with the DKIST using magneto-hydrodynamics simulations on a computer. In both cases, the vortices’ rotational speed and energy were the same. In other words, these whirlpools are essentially the sun’s engines: they capture the sun’s internal magnetic energy and radiate it out into the universe.

The simulations also suggested the whirlpools lie 100-400 km below the photosphere.

The findings give solar physicists a new way to investigate the boundary between convection and magnetism. The whirlpools generate turbulence and continuously distort the magnetic fields. In doing so, they could provide the small-scale motion needed to braid magnetic field lines and release magnetic energy higher in the atmosphere.

The next step is to determine how much energy these instabilities transport and how the small vortices are connected to the more energetic events of the sun’s atmosphere.

(Shamim Haque Mondal is with the Physics Division, State Forensic Science Laboratory, Kolkata. shamimmondal709@gmail.com)

THE GIST

New images captured by the world’s largest telescope have provided the clearest view yet of the sun’s surface, helping scientists better understand how energy and magnetic fields move through its atmosphere

Scientists used the Daniel K. Inouye Solar Telescope in Hawaii, which has a giant four metres mirror, to capture the sharpest images of the sun’s surface; its advanced imaging capabilities allowed researchers to observe tiny solar features that smaller telescopes could not detect

Scientists found that tiny plasma coils on the sun’s surface continuously move, twist and interact, and create fast-spinning whirlpools similar to those formed when strong winds disturb water. These vortices grow rapidly, merge and break apart within seconds, revealing a highly dynamic process never before observed

BIG SHOT



In this drone photo released by the Geological Agency (Badan Geologi) of Indonesia’s Ministry of Energy and Mineral Resources, Mount Anak Krakatau spews volcanic smoke in Sunda Strait, Indonesia on September 5. AP

WHAT IS IT?

Sulphuric acid: not so deadly

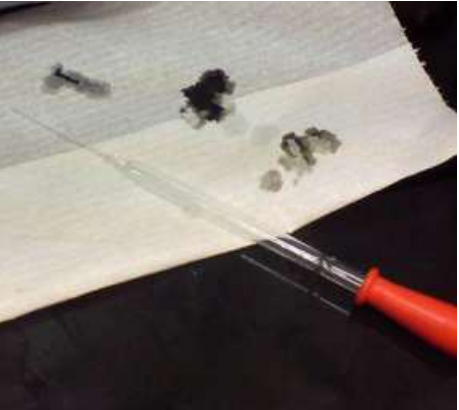
Vasudevan Mukunth

Researchers have found that certain peptides — short chains of amino acids that make up proteins — are not only stable in 98% concentrated sulphuric acid but also fold into the complex 3D shapes required to perform the functions central to life.

Thus, the findings, published *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences* on September 4, defy the assumption that concentrated sulphuric acid is a bane for the building blocks of life. Scientists had previously found nucleic acid bases and amino acids to be stable in the same solvent; this is the first time a macromolecule important to biology has been shown to be capable of the same feat.

Normally, strong acids break down peptides in a process called hydrolysis; as the name suggests, water molecules break down one or more important bonds. Since 98% sulphuric acid contains almost no water, the reaction that would normally shred the peptide bonds can’t happen, allowing the peptides to remain stable for several weeks at room temperature.

Using nuclear magnetic resonance spectroscopy, the researchers found that these peptides folded into a specific shape called an omega loop, using the sulphuric acid molecules themselves as a kind of scaffolding to help maintain the shape.



Drops of 98% concentrated sulphuric acid rapidly dehydrate tissue paper, leaving behind carbon, which stains it black. PUBLIC DOMAIN

This is however a significant departure from how proteins behave in water, where they typically form different structures like helices or sheets.

The findings are important for the search for life beyond the earth. For example, Venus is covered in clouds of concentrated sulphuric acid, which scientists previously assumed were too harsh an environment to host any complex chemistry. The new findings question this assumption.



For feedback and suggestions for ‘Science’, please write to **science@thehindu.co.in** with the subject ‘Daily page’

Text & Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Goal speed of Indian Railways' hydrogen train

110 in kmph. The Indian Railways is working to operate the country's first hydrogen-powered train at speeds of up to 110 kmph after completing trials at 120 kmph, Railway Board Chairman and CEO Satish Kumar said. He said consultations were under way with all stakeholders to decide the rail sections on which the new hydrogen train could be operated. PTI

Number of people dead in Israel strikes in Lebanon

4 Lebanon said four people were killed on Sunday in strikes that Israel said it carried out after Hezbollah had launched drones at its soldiers in south Lebanon, the latest escalation amid a fragile truce. Lebanon's Health Ministry reported two people killed in south Lebanon's Nabatieh al-Fawqa and two women killed in nearby Arab Salim. It said 20 other people were wounded. AFP

Number of people affected by floods in Bihar

19.57 in lakh. Over 19 lakh people across 11 districts of Bihar have been affected by floods. Due to the rise in water levels of various rivers in the State, people in 330 gram panchayats across 11 districts — Patna, Bhojpur, Saran, Vaishali, Bhagalpur, Begusarai, Buxar, Samastipur, Munger, Katihar and Araria — have been affected, the officials said. PTI

Flights affected by Indonesia volcanic eruption

209 Indonesia halted operations at its main international airport outside Jakarta on Sunday after ash spewed from the Anak Krakatoa volcano more than 150 kilometres away, impacting thousands of passengers. Mount Anak Krakatoa erupted on Saturday, producing a fountain of lava and booming sounds that could be heard up to 700 kms. AFP

Percentage of voters deleted in Sikkim in SIR exercise

11 in per cent. A total of 52,551 electors were deleted from Sikkim's electoral roll during the Special Intensive Revision (SIR), reducing the number of voters by around 11.16%, a statement said. The final roll has 4,18,467 eligible voters, compared with 4,71,018 in the pre-SIR voters' list, the Chief Electoral Officer's office said in a statement. PTI

COMPILED BY THE HINDU DATA TEAM

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Does inflation targeting work in India?

India's Phillips curve is found to be flat, while households' inflation expectations remain consistently higher than the RBI's projections; this suggests that inflation targeting can lower output and employment without a commensurate reduction in inflation

ECONOMIC NOTES

Rohit Azad
Indranil Chowdhury

India has just completed a decade of inflation targeting (IT) as a formal policy framework of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI). Under this framework, the RBI is supposed to contain inflation at 4% within a band of (+/-) 2 percentage points. In this piece, we explain the theory behind inflation targeting and test it against the Indian experience.

Managing demands

The RBI seeks to control inflation through two channels: controlling demand and influencing the public's inflationary expectations. The RBI flexes its policy rate of interest (called the repo rate), which is increased when inflation kicks in. This pushes commercial banks' lending rates up.

Households become wary of taking home or consumer loans, while businesses postpone decisions to build factories. Demand comes down and, as a result, so does inflation.

The second route works through anchoring the inflationary expectations of the public at large. The assumption is that high expectations about inflation tomorrow influence inflation today because capitalists build these expectations into their current pricing decisions and workers into their wage decisions. Inflation is a self-fulfilling prophecy. So, if the RBI can somehow tether these expectations to its projected path of inflation, it can contain this prophecy. Both these routes work through a relationship called the New Keynesian Phillips curve (NKPC).

This curve describes a relationship between the level of GDP and inflation in an economy. It is proposed that a rise in output leads to an increase in inflation. Prices are a markup over costs. For simplicity, let us assume wages are the only costs in an economy. Workers demand wages; capitalists add a profit margin to determine prices. If wages rise, prices follow suit. But why should wages rise with output?

The wage-price negotiation process provides the key to understanding the NKPC. Consider a worker who would like to buy 5 kg of rice during a month for her family. Since she will not receive a sack of rice as her wage, she will have to settle for a money wage with which she can buy that amount of rice.

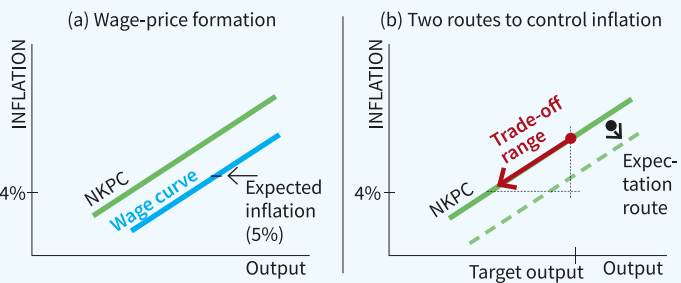
The time difference between fluctuations in money wages and the purchase of rice makes expectations a key factor in the process. For example, if she expects the price of 1 kg of rice at the time of purchase to be ₹100, she would negotiate for ₹500 as wages to buy those 5 kg. But if she expects the price to be ₹200, she would ask for ₹1,000. Wage costs would go up (for the same bundle of wage goods), as would prices.

A rise in output and employment, this framework argues, makes workers stronger and enables them to demand more rice — say from 5 kg to 6 kg — for the same number of hours of work. Thus, the wage demand curve rises with output (see panel (a) of **Graph 1**). Since prices are nothing but a markup over costs, the price curve (NKPC) has the same upward-sloping shape. On top of that, if the price expectations for rice were to change from ₹100 to ₹200, the wage demand curve, and the corresponding NKPC, would shift up for every level of

Off the mark

Ten years into inflation targeting, the Indian experience raises questions about its underlying assumptions

Graph 1: The New Keynesian Phillips Curve (NKPC)



Graph 2: A flat curve means lower output without lower inflation

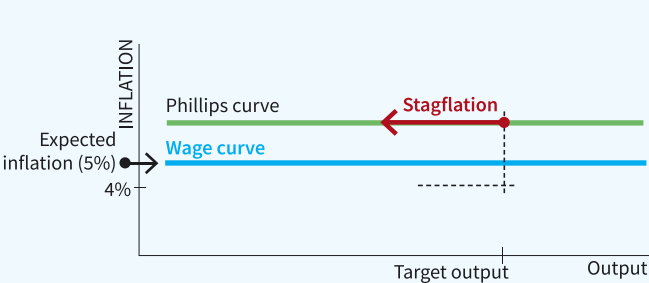


Chart 1: Testing the Phillips curve in India

April 2012 to March 2026

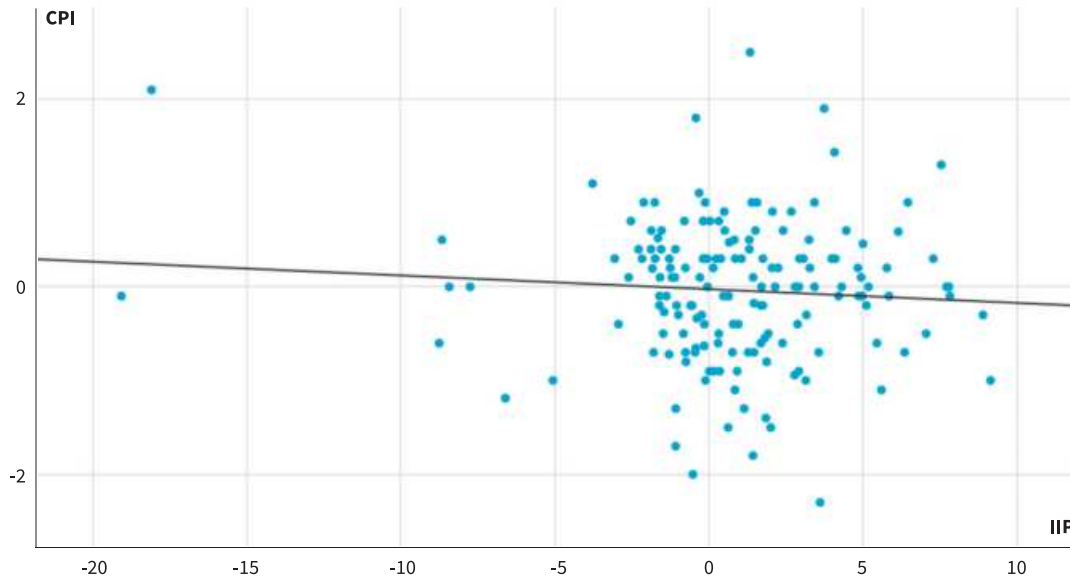


Chart: Azad & Chowdhury. Source: Database on Indian Economy, RBI

Chart 2(a): Household inflation expectations versus RBI projections

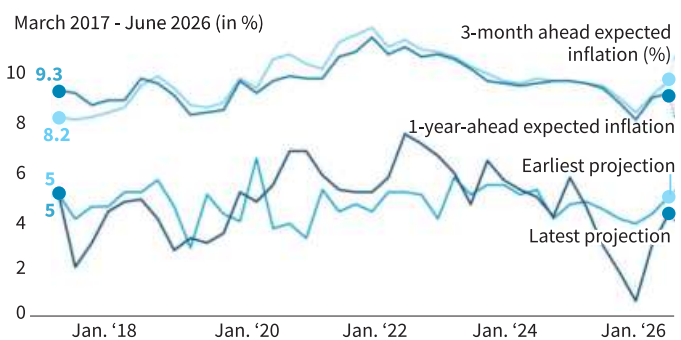


Chart: Azad & Chowdhury. Source: Households' Inflation Expectations Survey and Monetary Policy Statements, Various Years, RBI

Chart 2b: Household expected inflation and actual CPI inflation



Chart: Azad & Chowdhury. Source: Database on Indian Economy, RBI

output/ employment. In other words, the position of the NKPC is determined by expectations, and its slope by the bargaining power of workers and capitalists.

If the economy were to behave in this manner, there are two obvious ways to bring inflation under control (see panel (b) of Graph 1). Slide the economy down along the NKPC curve (the trade-off range marked in the graph where both inflation and output fall) or manoeuvre workers' expectations to a lower level across the board, so that the wage demand curve, hence the NKPC, shifts down, resulting in a fall in inflation with no impact on output. Expectation management is a less painful way of managing inflation. This is inflation targeting in a nutshell.

All of this works well in theory. But what if the real picture of the Indian economy is depicted in **Graph 2**? What if the NKPC is flat and there is no trade-off between output and inflation? Additionally, what if people's expectations do not match the RBI's projections of lower inflation in the future — that is, the flat NKPC stays put instead of shifting down? Then, a policy of inflation targeting, which brings output down without lowering inflation at all, leads to a combination of lower output and flat

stagflation (a left-pointed arrow in Graph 2).

Is the Indian Phillips curve upward sloping?

Our academic work published in the Economic and Political Weekly provides a more rigorous test of the Phillips curve, finding it to be flat under multiple configurations and methodologies. For the present purposes, a 'first cut' of that story is presented here. **Chart 1** uses monthly data on industrial output, as measured by the Index of Industrial Production (IIP), and CPI inflation between April 2012 and March 2026. The best-fit trend line in Chart 1 shows India's NKPC is, at best, flat.

But why is there such a gap between reality and mainstream economic theory? Because the basic premise of a rising wage demand curve, and consequently NKPC, as shown in Graph 1, is incorrect. For economies such as ours, an overwhelming majority of workers (around 92%) do not have any bargaining power, let alone fixing wages. They are simply price takers. Wages do not rise with output/employment.

Projections and expectations

Even if the Phillips curve is flat, IT

enthusiasts would argue that shifting it down would still do the job. But for this to happen, people's expectations should, by and large, match the RBI's projections. What does the Indian data tell us? The RBI surveys Indian households about their inflation expectations a quarter and one year ahead. These expectations are plotted over this period against the RBI's own projections. **Chart 2(a)** shows that expectations are consistently higher than the projections, that too, on average, by a margin of four percentage points. Even when expectations are plotted against actual inflation, the gap is similar (see **Chart 2(b)**). So, the expectations story is way off what is claimed to defend IT.

John Maynard Keynes would have asked the RBI: 'When facts change, I change my mind. What do you do sir?' Unfortunately, the RBI does the opposite as it tries to force-fit a macroeconomic model to a world where the underlying assumptions of the model do not hold. In the process, it inflicts pain on the common people of this country by forcing them out of employment without any commensurate gain in controlling inflation.

(The authors are a part of the DevMac (Development Macroeconomics) network, which seeks pluralism in Economics)

THE GIST

Inflation targeting works through higher interest rates to curb demand and through managing people's expectations of future inflation

The theory assumes that higher output and employment strengthen workers' bargaining power, pushing up wages and prices. However, this assumption does not hold well in India, where most workers have little bargaining power

The inflation-targeting framework relies on macroeconomic assumptions that may not reflect the realities of the Indian economy, potentially imposing high costs on employment and ordinary households

CACHE



Music lovers worldwide are noticing signs of AI tracks in both online and offline spaces, even as they call for greater transparency. GETTY IMAGES

Why Australia’s music industry banned AI music in chart listing

Australia’s ARIA has barred wholly AI-generated songs from its charts while allowing music made substantially by humans with AI assistance; the move has intensified calls for transparent AI labelling and greater accountability from streaming platforms

Sahana Venugopal

The story so far: Australia’s music industry body – the Australian Recording Industry Association (ARIA) – on August 25 banned songs wholly made using AI, noting such tracks will be ineligible for listing on its charts. The announcement comes after the viral fame of an AI remix of Madonna’s 1989 song ‘Like a Prayer,’ made by Australian music producer and disc jockey Josh Fawaz earlier this year. The AI song enjoyed multiple weeks on the country’s top 20 chart and ranked second on ARIA’s top 20 Australian singles chart, per AP. It also scored over 23 million views on YouTube.

The use of AI to compose the song was not clearly disclosed initially, angering listeners and musicians who want synthetic music to be transparently labelled.

Which songs are banned under the new rules? The industry body ARIA’s rules do not ban outright the use of AI in music. Neither does it have a zero-tolerance policy for AI in art. Instead, the updated code notes that a recording developed with the help of Gen AI is eligible for listing when it is “substantially human made” and “raises no stream or chart manipulation concerns.” This still leaves a lot of room for artists to create music with Generative AI tools.

In fact, ARIA CEO Annabelle Herd

To truly exclude AI-generated music from human creations, even casual listeners need a reliable way to differentiate between the two; for this, transparent labelling standards are required across platforms

insisted that the chart listings should evolve to “keep room for” artists already using AI tools in their work. “The ARIA Charts will always remain a transparent measurement of the music Australia consumes, but a chart that rewards unlicensed AI output would undercut the very basis of the recorded music we exist to represent,” she said.

What penalties will users and distributors face? ARIA has stated that it may reject ineligible recordings, apart from excluding them and removing them from charts whenever needed, adjusting chart positions, withdrawing accreditations, or rescinding its awards. But when considering the global music industry as a whole, there is not much punitive action that original music artists and producers can take against users making AI-generated versions of their songs. The optics of a world-famous singer suing a small creator over an AI remix do not favour the true creators. Instead, musical artistes and the companies representing them have been taking AI music generation platforms such



as Suno and Udio to court, accusing them of using copyrighted works without permission. In late August, music publishers including Sony Music Publishing and Warner Chappell sued Anthropic, as well as its co-founders Dario Amodei and Benjamin Mann, alleging digital piracy and the data harvesting of copyrighted works. Anthropic disagreed with the claims and intends to defend itself in court, reported *TechCrunch*. Scraping copyrighted content to build AI is still a grey area. However, the 2025 ruling against Anthropic in the authors’ lawsuit that ended in a landmark \$1.5 billion settlement made one thing clear: that U.S. courts may take a more serious view of AI companies pirating copyrighted content for AI development.

Will music platforms be held accountable for AI? To truly exclude AI-generated music from human creations, even casual listeners need a reliable way to differentiate between the two at first glance. For this, transparent labelling standards are

required across streaming platforms such as Spotify and Apple Music. Later this month, Spotify users can expect to see “AI Persona” labels that identify artists who were entirely created with AI. In addition to this, Spotify will not include AI Personas in listeners’ editorial or algorithmic recommendations. The labels will depend on both self-disclosure as well as the platform’s own checking process. Users will also be able to learn if the artist self-disclosed their AI status, or if Spotify had to apply the label. While this label applies to AI artists, the platform has features such as AI Credits and SongDNA in order to understand if specific tracks were created with AI. But more users are asking for ways to filter AI-generated or AI-assisted music entirely. A spike in unlabelled AI song tracks on platforms such as Instagram makes it difficult for creators to curate background music for their videos and photos. For example, art-based businesses marketing handmade goods to buyers can face flak over accidentally using AI music in their Reels. Taking down and re-uploading the Reel would cost them views. Challenges exist offline as well. Music lovers and connoisseurs have complained that AI soundtracks are seeping into more public spaces, as commercial properties such as stores and cafés err on the side of caution by choosing generic AI music over popular licensed tracks they may need to pay for.

THE DAILY QUIZ

Identify these personalities from their Wikipedia page subheadings

Mohammed Hidayat

- QUESTION 1

Childhood - Public speaker - Pune Ashram - Arrival in the United States - 1984 bioterror attack.
- QUESTION 2

Early life - Mathematics career - Life in Montana - Mail bombings - Manifesto.
- QUESTION 3

Early life - Founding a blood-testing startup - Self-made female billionaire - Downfall - Fraud charges.
- QUESTION 4

Early life - Career - Photography hobby - Later years - Death - Discovery and recognition - Legacy.
- QUESTION 5

Early religious and political influences - Founding a new religious organisation - Relocation to a South American country - Mass murder-suicide.
- QUESTION 6

Early life - Led own gang - Massacre - Surrender - Political career - Assassination.



Visual Question: Identify the African leader and fill in the blank. Early life - Rise in Army - Seizure of power - Expulsion of _____ - War with Tanzania - Exile - Death - Erratic behaviour, self-bestowed titles and media portrayal. AP

Questions and Answers to the previous day’s daily quiz: 1. What was the name of the feminist magazine she co-founded in 1971 which survives till today? **Ans: Ms. magazine** 2. Steinem said once that she had never wanted children because she already had one. Who was she referring to? **Ans: Her mother** 3. Steinem was part of the second wave of feminism. Name the book credited with launching this wave, written by Betty Friedan. **Ans: The Feminine Mystique** 4. In 2005, Steinem, Robin Morgan, and X co-founded an organisation that “works to make women visible and

powerful in the media.” Name X, an actor who starred in Klute and Coming Home. **Ans: Jane Fonda** 5. In a controversial op-ed, Steinem once defended a U.S. President, saying his behaviour with women may have been reckless, but did not meet the legal definition of sexual harassment or assault. Which President was she talking about? **Ans: Bill Clinton** Visual: Where did she work, which led to her seminal 1963 undercover exposé, ‘A Bunny’s Tale’? **Ans: The Playboy Club** **Early Birds:** Dodo Jayaditya | Prem Nath Tiwari | Rony S. Emmanuel | Sukdev Shet | Tamal Biswas



KNOW YOUR ENGLISH

Getting him to open up is like pulling teeth

Students urged to think rather than parrot textbook answers

S. Upendran

“It was good to see your mother after nearly three years. Will she be here for some time?” “Maybe for another two weeks. She said that you’d put on weight.” “She told me the same thing. I’ve been trying to lose weight for the past six months, but it’s like pulling teeth.” “Pulling teeth? Getting one’s tooth pulled is not an enjoyable experience. Was my mom saying you’re going to have a problem losing weight?” “The expression ‘pulling teeth’ has several different meanings – all of them negative. When you say that completing a task was like pulling teeth, it means it was a slow and painful process.” “There were times when you just wanted to throw your hands into the air, and walk away!” “That’s right! Trying to have a conversation with Renu was like pulling teeth.” “How about this example? For many people, getting up early in the morning is like pulling teeth.” “That’s a good example. My parents had a tough time waking me up when I was in school.” “Talking about school. Unlike most people I know, you never talk about your school days. Getting information from you about your school days is like pulling teeth.” “You’ll find that pulling teeth is a lot easier than getting me to talk about my school days.” “In that case, I will stop asking questions related to that phase of your life.” “Thank you. So, what’s been...” “Tell me, what’s the difference between ‘aping someone’ and ‘parrotting someone’?” “Tell me, what does a parrot do?” “It flies around and” “That’s not what I mean. When you talk to your pet parrot which has been with you for a while, what does it do?” “When I say something, it sometimes repeats what I said.” “Exactly! It repeats what you’ve said. Doesn’t really say anything new, does it?” “It’s not capable of saying anything new.” “Which is why the expression ‘to parrot someone’ carries with it the sense that it is mindless repetition...” “In other words, when you parrot someone, you are saying things without really understanding what you’re saying.” “Exactly! The Vice Principal parrots whatever the principal says.” “My boss hates that. He doesn’t want anyone to merely parrot what he says.” “Such people are difficult to find. Unlike his sister, Ravi is not very bright. He merely parrots everything she says.” “So, now tell me, what does ‘ape someone’ mean?” “When you ape someone, you mimic someone. In this case, what you do is to copy his mannerisms, style, the way of walking, talking, etc. And you do a very bad job of it.” “We tried to ape our favourite rock band.” “That sounds good. Children frequently ape their parents.” “We all do that when we are very young.” upendrankye@gmail.com

Word of the day

Shibboleth: a favourite saying of a group, organisation, or individual
Synonyms: slogan, motto, idiom, tagline
Usage: The phrase became a shibboleth among university students.
Pronunciation: newsth.live/shibboleth
International Phonetic Alphabet: /ʃɪbəlθ/

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